



CONTENTS

1	Charge	3
1.0.1	Point Charge	5
1.0.2	Superposition	6
1.1	Electric Field	7
1.2	Dipoles	9
1.3	Electric Flux and Gauss's law	10
1.3.1	Gauss's law	11
1.4	Continuous Charge Distributions	11
1.4.1	Charge Densities	11
1.5	Electric Potential	13
1.5.1	Point Charges, Uniform Fields, and Spherical Shells	15
1.5.2	Potential due to Configurations of Charge	16
1.5.3	Conservation of Energy	16
1.5.4	Summary	17
1.6	Lightning	17
1.7	But...	18
2	Alternating Current	21
2.1	Power of AC	21
2.2	Power Line Losses	23
2.3	Transformers	23
2.4	Phase and 3-phase power	24
3	Electromagnetic Induction	27

3.1	Faraday's Law of Induction	27
3.1.1	Magnetic Flux	27
3.2	Lenz's Law	28
3.3	Induction in a Coil	28
3.4	Applications of Electromagnetic Induction	29
4	Electric Motor	31
4.1	Basic Electric Motor	31
4.2	Basic Electric Generator	31
5	Drag	35
5.1	Wind resistance	35
5.2	Initial velocity and acceleration due to gravity	36
5.3	Simulating artillery in Python	37
5.4	Terminal velocity	39
6	Parametric Functions	41
6.1	Conversion to Rectangular Form	42
6.2	Sketching Parametric Equations	43
6.3	Using Python to Explore Parametric Curves	45
6.4	Derivatives of Parametric Functions	48
6.5	Length of Curve Traced by Parametric Equations	52
7	Vector-valued Functions	55
7.1	Vector-valued functions: position	55
7.2	Finding the velocity vector	56
7.3	Finding the acceleration vector	56
8	Circular Motion	59
8.1	Introduction to Uniform Circular Motion	59
8.2	The Flying Billiard Ball	60
8.3	Velocity	62
8.4	Acceleration	64
8.5	Centripetal force	66
8.5.1	Banked Turns	68
8.6	Modeling Circular Motion	70
8.7	Flying Pigs and Tension	72
8.8	Non-uniform circular motion	75
8.8.1	Roller Coaster Loop	75

	3
A Answers to Exercises	81
Index	93

Charge

If you rub a balloon against your hair, then place it next to a wall, it will stick. Why does this happen? This is exactly what will be explored in this chapter on **charge** and **electrostatics**. This is because the balloon has stripped some electrons from your hair, and now the balloon has slightly more electrons than protons. We say that it has gotten an *net electrical charge*, or an imbalance between protons and electrons. While any **friction** or contact between two objects can cause a difference in electric charge, *net charge cannot be created or destroyed*. In this case, the balloon has a negative electrical charge. Objects with slightly more protons than electrons have a positive charge. Consequently, your hair now has a positive charge. Note that the differences are equal but opposite.

An object with a negative charge and an object with a positive charge will be *attracted* to each other. Two objects with the same charge will be *repelled* by each other. This charge originates from a subatomic level, when protons (positively charged) and electrons (negatively charged) are present in an atom at *unequal amounts*.

This charge, referred to as *elementary charge* is represented by the base unit e (not to be confused with the e^x function in math disciplines). This value, known as the elementary charge (e), represents the smallest indivisible unit of electric charge. Much like counting physical coins, you cannot have a "fractional" coin. Similarly, an object's net charge must be an integer multiple of e . In physics, we describe this property by saying that charge is quantized ($Q = ne$ where n is an integer).

In this way, we call elementary charge *quantized*. This was shown back in Because it is quantized, we represent the charge of a particle as q . The SI (International System of Units) measures charge in *coulombs*. The charge of a single proton is about 1.6×10^{-19} coulombs.

Two objects with charges are bound to either attract (pull) or repel (push) on each other. This is a type of force referred to as *electric force*.

Coulomb's Law

If two objects with charge q_1 and q_2 (in coulombs) are r meters from each other, the force of attraction or repulsion (electric force) is given by

$$F = k \frac{q_1 q_2}{r^2} \quad (1.1)$$

where F is in newtons and K is Coulomb's constant: about 8.988×10^9 . You may use $9 \times 10^9 \text{ N} \cdot \text{m}^2/\text{C}$ in your calculations.

This k value comes from $\frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0}$, a *relationship with the permittivity of free space*, ϵ_0 .¹ You may see this as F_e , F_q , or F_c , but they all refer to the electric force and the standard is F_e .

Note how similar this looks to Newton's Law of Universal Gravitation:

$$F_g = G \frac{m_1 m_2}{r^2}$$

Both laws follow an inverse-square relationship, meaning the force decreases with the square of the distance. However, gravity is always attractive, while electric force can be either attractive or repulsive depending on the signs of the charges (q_1 and q_2).

If this force is negative, it represents the idea that the two given particles are attracted to each other, as this would mean one of the particles must have a negative charge.

If this force is positive, it would mean there is a push or repelling force on each of the particles.

What if this force is zero? This would only result if one or both particles have zero charge. This would mean that they do not have an electric force, $F_E = 0$.

Exercise 1 Coulomb's Law

Working Space

Two balloons are charged with an identical quantity and type of charge: -5×10^{-9} coulombs. They are held apart at a separation distance of 12 cm. Determine the magnitude of the electrical force of repulsion between them.

Answer on Page 81

¹A note on the permittivity of free space: ϵ_0 (or the electric constant) represents the capability of a vacuum to permit electric field lines. Its exact value in SI units is $\epsilon_0 \approx 8.854 \times 10^{-12} \text{ C}^2/(\text{N} \cdot \text{m}^2)$. This tells us that the speed of light isn't just a number but rather it is strictly determined by how quickly the universe can allow electric and magnetic fields to change. Using k allows for quick math, especially when fields become spherical and the π factor is eliminated easily.

At this point, you might ask “If the wall has zero charge, why is the balloon attracted to it?” The answer: the electrons in the wall move away from the balloon, polarizing the atoms. The negative charge on the balloon pushes electrons away from itself, so the surface of the wall gets a mild positive charge. The negative charge on the balloon is attracted more to the positive charge on the surface of the wall than the negative charge on the inside, thus the balloon sticks. This is due to the idea of *conductors* and *insulators*.



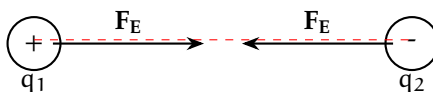
Figure 1.1: The negative balloon repels the wall’s electrons, leaving a net positive surface. The balloon is then attracted to this induced positive charge.

Recall that a **conductor** is a type of material through which valence electrons (electrons in the outer shell) easily flows, and an **insulator** is a type of material through which charge does not easily flow, if at all. Metals, such as copper or zinc, are the best conductors because the electrons within the atoms are not tied to a nucleus, but rather form a sparse collection or sea in which the charge can flow through. Insulators like plastic, rubber, or glass prevent charge flowing through as the electrons are tightly bound to their parent atoms or molecules.

1.0.1 Point Charge

The wall and the balloon all contain a bunch of tiny particles which we can refer to as **point charges**. A point charge is an electric charge that is treated as a concentrated single point in space, with no physical size or volume. Similar to point masses, we use point charges to simulate effects of charge on other objects or points.

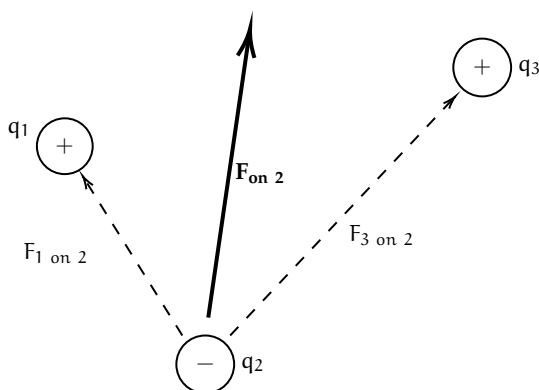
This charge acts parallel to the secant line that touches both point charges only once.



1.0.2 Superposition

What if there are more just one charges acting on a given point charge? Coulomb's law gives the force between two point charges, but in a system with three or more charges we apply the **principle of superposition**².

The principle of superposition states that the total electric force on a charge is the vector sum of the individual forces exerted on it by all other charges.³



Exercise 2 Finding net charge on a point charges

Working Space

This question is taken from the AP Physics C 19th edition practice workbook.

Consider four equal, positive point charges that are situated at the vertices of a square. Find the net electric force on a negative point charge placed at the square's center.

Hint: draw a diagram to help you

Answer on Page 81

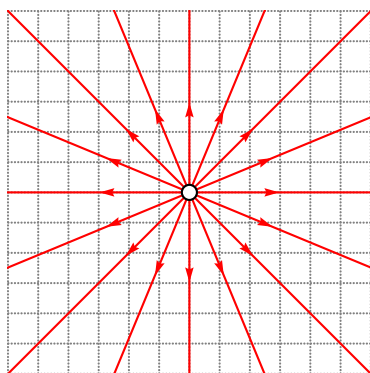
²Superposition is really a linear algebra topic, and not something that this textbook will cover, but it has so many real life applications and we recommend you do your own research! See the wiki page for more: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Superposition_principle

³This is similar how we calculate tensions when there are multiple tensions (or just forces in general) on an object. The net force is the sum of all the forces after vector addition is applied.

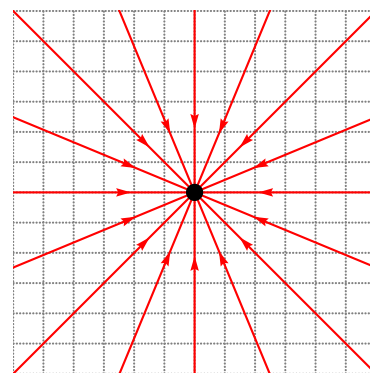
1.1 Electric Field

Recall that, when we talked about Gravitational Fields, we defined them as fields of infinitesimal points that each have a magnitude of force associated with them. This field revolves around the entire 2D circle or 3D sphere (generally point masses, charges, fields, etc are spherical).

Similar to how the gravitational field extends out from the center of a given point mass, an *electric field* of a point charge has (imaginary) vectors pointing out of it. However, the direction of the vectors⁴ (and electric force) depends on the charge of the point charge. A negatively charged point mass has force lines pointing *towards* it, and a positively charged point mass has force lines pointing *away* from it (1.2a). In short, they always originate from positive charges and approach negative charges.



(a) A positively (open circle) charged electric field with corresponding electric field lines.



(b) A negatively (filled circle) charged electric field with corresponding electric field lines.

Figure 1.2: Two electric fields with different charges.

What are the *units* of an electric field? Well, by this equation, $\vec{F}_e$ is a force which we know is in *Newtons* (N), and the test particle q is in *Coulombs* (C). The resulting units are N C^{-1} , or *Newton's per Coulomb*. Note that this is equivalent to 1 V m^{-1} , or one *Volt per meter*⁵. This is how electric field forces are converted to volts within batteries or circuits!

It is important to note that we can simplify this equation by substituting Coulomb's law:

$$\vec{E} = \frac{\vec{F}_e}{q_t} = \frac{\frac{kq_1q_t}{r^2}}{q_t} = \frac{kQ}{r^2} \quad (1.2)$$

where Q is the electric field's source charge.

⁴You may hear the terms electric field lines and electric field vectors used interchangeably

⁵Equivalently, one kV cm^{-1} , or kilovolt per centimeter is equal to $10^{-5} \times 1 \text{ N C}^{-1}$. To reverse the operation, multiply the kilovolts per centimeter by 10^5 to get the resulting Newtons per Coulomb

For positive charges Q , the force vectors get weaker the farther from the charge (visually, the force lines get shorter). In fact, it decreases by a factor of $\frac{1}{r^2}$. Think to yourself where this factor comes from. (Hint: refer back to Coulomb's law (1.1))

Electric Field Force from a singular charge to a second charge

A charge q_1 creates an electric field at a distance r from it with strength:

$$E = \frac{kq_1}{r^2} \quad (1.3)$$

Introducing a new charge q_2 , the force on it due to the electric field is:

$$F = q_2 \cdot \frac{kq_1}{r^2} \iff F = q_2 E \quad (1.4)$$

where E is the electric field strength at the location of q_2 . This is often referred to as the charge within a known field.

Exercise 3 Point Charges and Electric Fields

This problem is adapted from an Example IB Exam. Two isolated point charges, X of charge $+Q$ and Y of charge $+2Q$, are separated by distance $3d$. Point P is distance d from X and distance $2d$ from Y.



What is the net electric field strength at P? Are the forces from each charge equal?

1. 0, equal forces
2. $\frac{2kQ}{d^2}$, equal forces
3. $\frac{kQ}{2d^2}$, equal forces
4. $\frac{2kQ}{1.5d^2}$, equal forces

Working Space

Answer on Page 81

The density of the electric force lines at a given point determines the strength of the force at the point. Locations where field lines are more dense are much stronger than areas where the lines are sparse. This goes back to the idea of the force strength of an electric field.

If you recall the properties of conductors: *there can be no electrostatic field within the body of a conductor*. If an electric field were to exist inside the conductor, it would exert a force $F = qE$ on these free charges, causing them to accelerate. This internal motion continues until the charges redistribute themselves along the conductor's outer surface, creating an induced internal field that perfectly opposes and cancels the original field.

Electric field lines always

- Start at positive charges and terminate at negative ones. If it is a single charge, this is indicated by the direction of arrows off to infinity.
- The number of lines is proportional to the magnitude of charge.
- The line approaches a conductive surface perpendicularly.
- No two field lines ever cross in a charge-free region.

Keep these in mind for any sketches you may do.

1.2 Dipoles

An **electric dipole** is a set of two *point charges* that equal and opposite charges that are infinitesimally close together. Two point charges, one with charge $+q$ and the other one with charge $-q$ separated by a distance d , create an electric dipole.

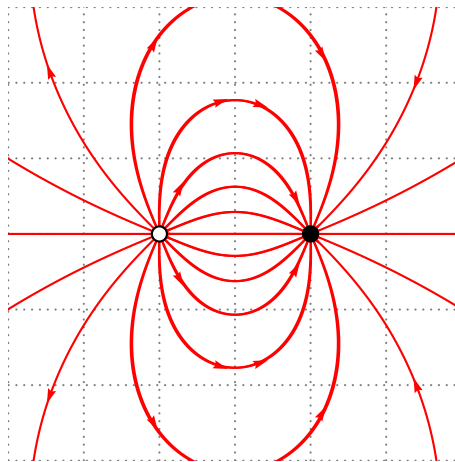


Figure 1.3: A basic dipole diagram.

Charge flows consistently from positive to negative, and has magnitude $\vec{p} = q\vec{d}$, where $\vec{p}$ is the dipole moment with units $C \cdot m$, or Coulomb-meters.

1.3 Electric Flux and Gauss's law

Electric Flux is the number of field lines that pass through a given surface. Represented by Φ , it is the measure of how much of an electric field itself passes through an area.

The electric flux depends on 3 factors:

- Electric Field Strength (E)
- Surface Area being measured, (A). A must be perpendicular to the field lines.
- Angle at which the area is relative to the field lines.

If the electric field lines are perpendicular to the area A , then the electric flux is

$$\Phi = \sum E \cdot A \quad (1.5)$$

Think of this as a paper directly perpendicular to a fan; the maximum amount of the paper is blown by the fan.

If the paper is at an angle to the fan, less flow from the fan affects the paper. If you tilt it until it's parallel to the wind, zero wind affects the paper. Similarly, the electric flux on a surface at a titled angle decreases how much flux is felt:

$$\Phi = \sum E \cdot A \cos(\theta) \quad (1.6)$$

In integral form (which we have not covered yet, so do not worry about using it), this is:

$$\Phi = \oint E \cdot dA \cos(\theta) \quad (1.7)$$

where the integral is on a closed area.

If you recall our discussion on resistance, flux and resistance are very similar measurements. In a wire, a larger cross-sectional area (A) is like a highway for electrons. It allows more electrons to pass through easily, which decreases the resistance. If you maximize flux by having a huge area, you are essentially creating a path with very low resistance for a current.

1.3.1 Gauss's law

So far, we have imagined the electric field is only 2-dimensional plane (a circle). What if we consider them as a 3-dimensional boundary, similar to gravitation? This introduces the idea of *Gauss's Law for Electric Fields*:

Gauss's Law

Gauss's law states that the strength of an electric field for 3-Dimensional object can be calculated by:

$$\Phi = \oint \vec{E} \cdot d\vec{A} \cos(\theta) = \frac{Q_{\text{enc}}}{\epsilon_0} \quad (1.8)$$

This is a formula for saying that every infinitesimal bit of a 2-Dimensional object is given a height and an electric strength, and this is equal to the enclosed area of the charge over the permittivity of free space constant.

For specifically spherically 3-Dimensional objects, inputting the formula for a sphere into A gives us:

$$E = \frac{q}{4\pi r^2 \epsilon_0} \quad (1.9)$$

where q is the source charge, r is the distance from that source charge, and $4\pi r^2$ is the surface area of the electric field. What this means is that electric field at all points r from the source charge are equal in magnitude. Pretty cool!

1.4 Continuous Charge Distributions

In the previous sections, we treated charges as discrete “dots” in space. However, in applications of charges such as a long charged wire, a flat metal plate, or a solid plastic sphere, charge is spread out over a macroscopic object. When we have a collection of so many point charges that they appear to form a smooth, “fluid-like” surface or volume, we call it a **continuous charge distribution**. This means that the charges, while not truly continuous, can be considered continuous as a long single stream.

To analyze these, we stop summing individual particles ($\sum$) and instead use calculus to integrate ($\int$) over the entire object. While we have not covered calculus yet, keep in mind that this is just a way of calculating the area or volume of a continuous solid.

1.4.1 Charge Densities

The first step in any continuous distribution problem is defining how the charge is spread. We use three Greek letters to represent the “concentration” of charge based on the object's

geometry:

Type	Symbol	Definition	SI Units
Linear	λ (lambda)	Charge per unit length	C/m
Surface	σ (sigma)	Charge per unit area	C/m ²
Volume	ρ (rho)	Charge per unit volume	C/m ³

Table 1.1: The three types of charge density used in electrostatics.

If the charge is distributed **uniformly**, these values stay constant. For example, for a rod of length L and total charge Q , the linear density is simply $\lambda = Q/L$. However, if these the charge is not constant per the unit of length, we must use calculus to find the total charge density. To find the total electric field $\vec{E}$ at a point P near a charged object, we imagine breaking the object into many infinitesimal "pieces" of charge, dq . Each chunk acts like a tiny point charge and contributes a tiny bit of electric field, $d\vec{E}$.

Recall our point charge formula:

$$d\vec{E} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{dq}{r^2} \quad (1.10)$$

To find the total field, we integrate over the entire distribution:

$$\vec{E} = \int d\vec{E} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \int \frac{dq}{r^2} \quad (1.11)$$

The key to solving these integrals is replacing dq with the appropriate density:

- Lines: $dq = \lambda dl$
- Surfaces: $dq = \sigma dA$
- Volumes: $dq = \rho dV$

For now, you will not be quizzed on these integrals but know of their existence and that charge can be treated as a virtual stream along an object. This is why any part of the balloon from our first example will stick to any part of the wall.

Exercise 4 Belt being charged*Working Space*

This question is from an IB Electromagnetics problem. A continuous conveyor belt of width 0.60 m travels at a constant speed of 2.5 ms^{-1} . The belt has a uniform distribution of charge of 5.0 mCm^{-2} on the surface. As the belt passes a point A, all the charge is transferred into the wire with width along the horizontal of the belt.

What is the charge on the wire? *Hint: recall that current is $\frac{\Delta Q}{\Delta t}$.*

*Answer on Page 82***1.5 Electric Potential**

Let's talk about electric potential and electric potential energy. Recall that objects can have *kinetic* and *potential* energy, that potential energy is gradually transported into kinetic energy.

Electric Potential describes the amount of work, W_E , done by an electric force. The change in **electric potential energy** is defined as the work done on that force:

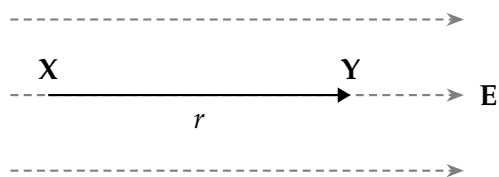
$$\Delta U_E = -W_E \quad (1.13)$$

Notice how this is similar to an object of mass m undergoing work done by a gravitational field $\Delta U_G = -W_G$.

Exercise 5 Change in Electric Potential Energy

Working Space

A positive charge $+q$ moves a distance r from position X to position Y in a **uniform** electric field E .



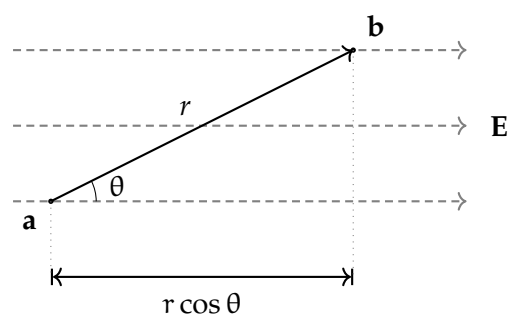
What is its change in electric potential energy? Assume moving in direction r moves in the direction of E .

Answer on Page 82

Electric Potential (V) is the amount of work needed to move a test charge q_t from a reference point to a specific point in a static electric field. It describes the potential for a charge to have energy at that location, regardless of whether a charge is actually there. Electric Potential Energy (U_E) per unit charge where ($V = U_E/q$).

Just as moving a mass up in height against gravity increases its gravitational potential, moving a positive charge "up" against an electric field increases its electric potential. In both cases, the field *tries* to push the object toward a state of lower potential energy. A positive charge naturally wants to move with the electric field toward lower potential; in this case, its electric potential energy is converted into kinetic energy. Conversely, to move a positive charge against an electric field, work must be done on the charge, causing its electric potential to increase.

Moving from two points not on the same electric field line introduces an angle component θ :



The electric potential difference between two points A and B is defined by the line

Figure 1.4: A gain of potential energy across an angle.

integral of the electric field:

$$\Delta V = V_B - V_A = - \int_A^B \vec{E} \cdot d\vec{l} \quad (1.14)$$

The negative sign indicates that the potential decreases in the direction of the electric field.

We can easily define two point charges q_1 and q_2 sep-

arated by distance r to have potential energy

$$U = k \frac{q_1 q_2}{r} = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{q_1 q_2}{r} \quad (1.15)$$

Exercise 6 Accelerating an Electron

This is a sample problem from an IB Physics Exam. An elec-

tron is accelerated from rest by an electric potential difference V . The electron reaches a speed of 9.4×10^6 m/s. Using the charge of an electron as $e = 1.6 \times 10^{-19}$ C and the mass of an electron as $m_e = 9.11 \times 10^{-31}$ kg, find the potential difference V that accelerated the electron to this speed. You may use a calculator to simplify computations.

Answer on Page 83

1.5.1 Point Charges, Uniform Fields, and Spherical Shells

In a **uniform electric field** (such as the space between two large parallel plates), the field strength E is constant. The potential difference between two points separated by a distance d along the field lines is:

$$\Delta V = -Ed \quad (1.16)$$

For a **point charge** Q , we typically set the reference point ($V = 0$) at infinity. The potential at a distance r from the charge is:

$$V = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{Q}{r} \quad (1.17)$$

Unlike the electric field, which is a vector and follows an $1/r^2$ factor, electric potential is a **scalar** and follows an $1/r$ factor.

Surface Spherical Charge

For all spherical objects of radius R (surface spheres - assume hollow interior), it has potential inside and outside of the shell. For all points outside the shell, it is the same for any point charge Q , as seen in equation 1.17. For all points *inside* the shell, the potential is

$$V = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{Q}{R}$$

This means that moving a test charge q from the surface of the shell to the center of the shell, the potential does not change. The potential is constant within the shell.

When the sphere is *not hollow*, the interior charge changes to:

$$k = \frac{1}{4\pi\epsilon_0} \frac{Q}{2R} \left(3 - \frac{r^2}{R^2} \right)$$

1.5.2 Potential due to Configurations of Charge

Because potential is a scalar, finding the total potential from multiple charges is often simpler than finding the total electric field. We do not need to worry about components, instead, we simply sum the potentials:

$$V = \sum_i \frac{kq_i}{r_i} \quad \text{or for continuous distributions} \quad V = k \int \frac{dq}{r} \quad (1.18)$$

1.5.3 Conservation of Energy

When a charge q moves through a potential difference ΔV , the change in its electric potential energy is $\Delta U_E = q\Delta V$. If no other forces are acting on the charge, the total mechanical energy is conserved:

$$K_a + U_{E,a} = K_b + U_{E,b} \implies \frac{1}{2}mv_a^2 + qV_a = \frac{1}{2}mv_b^2 + qV_b \quad (1.19)$$

1.5.4 Summary

Particle	wants to move toward...	Potential Change (ΔV)	Potential Energy Change (U_E)
Positive (+q)	Lower Potential	Negative (Decreases)	Negative (Decreases)
Negative (−q)	Higher Potential	Positive (Increases)	Negative (Decreases)

Exercise 7 Electron between Field Plates

This is a sample problem from an IB Physics Exam. An electron that is travelling at a horizontal speed $v_x = 9.4 \times 10^6 \text{ ms}^{-1}$ now enters a region of a *uniform electric field* between two parallel charged plates, separated by a distance of 4.0 cm. The electron is initially halfway between the plates and its initial velocity is parallel to the plates. The upper plate is positively charged and the lower plate is negatively charged. There is a potential difference between the plates of $V = 30 \text{ V}$.

Find the horizontal distance travelled before hitting a plate. Which plate does the electron hit?

Working Space

Answer on Page 83

1.6 Lightning

A cloud is a cluster of water droplets and ice particles. These droplets and ice particles are always moving up and down through the cloud. Recall that heat rises, so water is often trying to get higher in the cloud. In this process, electrons get stripped off and end up on the water droplets at the bottom of the cloud (water droplets collect at the bottom because they are denser). The air between the droplets is a pretty good insulator, which means the electrons are reluctant to jump anywhere. However, eventually, the charge gets so strong that even the insulating properties of the air is not enough to prevent the jump to earth, causing lightning. *Storms* are dense in clouds, so there is constant jumping of the electrons, which is why storms are prone to producing so much lightning. These electrons really want to jump to earth, and when given enough time and ability to bypass the air's

density. The electrons energy is visible as light and heat, and so we see a spark in the shape of a jagged line hitting a single point, the most conductive point on earth closest to the cloud. A great deal of lightning moves within a cloud or between clouds. However, sometimes it jumps to the earth. These bolts of lightning vary in the amount of electrons they carry, but the average is about 15 coulombs.

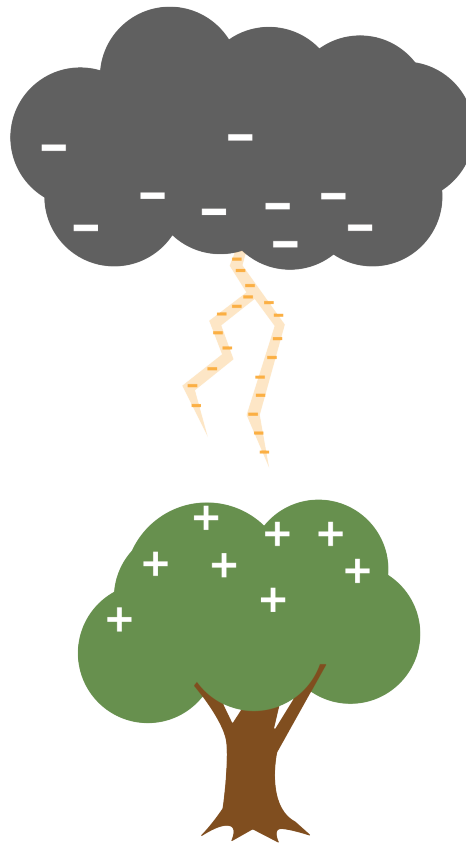


Figure 1.5: A difference of charge causes a spark of lightning to generate and transfer.

Thunder occurs because the electrons heat the air they pass through, causing the air to expand suddenly. The resulting shockwave is the sound we know as thunder.

1.7 But...

This idea that opposite charges attract creates some heavy questions that you do not yet have the tools to work with. So to these questions, the answer is basically “Don’t ask that yet!”

However, you probably have these questions, so we will point you in the direction of the

answers.

The first is “In any atom bigger than hydrogen, there are multiple protons in the nucleus. Why don’t the protons push each other out of the nucleus?”

We aren’t ready to talk about it, but there is a force called *the strong nuclear force*, which pulls the protons and neutrons in the nucleus of the atom toward each other. At very, very small distances, it is strong enough to overpower the repulsive force due to the protons’ charges.

Another question is “Why do the electrons whiz around in a cloud so far from the nucleus of the atom? Negatively charged electrons should cling to the protons in the center, right?”

We aren’t ready to talk about this either, but quantum mechanics tells us that electrons like to live in a certain specific energy level. Hugging protons isn’t one of those levels.

CHAPTER 2

Alternating Current

We have discussed the voltage and current created by a battery. A battery pushes the electrons in one direction at a constant voltage; this is known as *Direct Current* or DC. A battery typically provides between 1.5 and 9 volts.

The electrical power that comes into your home on wires is different. If you plotted the voltage over time, it would look like this:

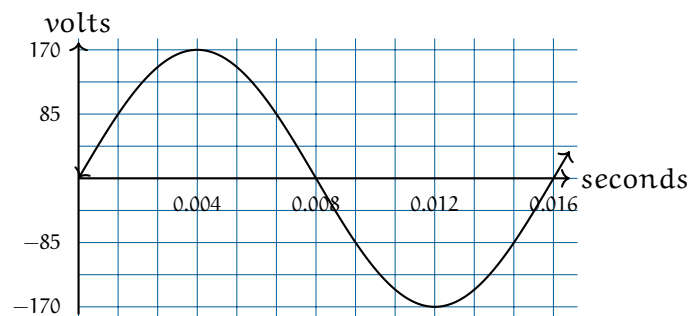


Figure 2.1: A graph of AC voltage over time.

The x axis here represents ground. When you insert a two-prong plug into an outlet, one is “hot” and the other is “ground”. Ground represents 0 volts and should be the same voltage as the dirt under the building.

The voltage is a sine wave at 60Hz. Your voltage fluctuates between -170v and 170v. Think for a second what that means: The power company pushes electrons at 170v, then pulls electrons at 170v. It alternates back and forth this way 60 times per second.

2.1 Power of AC

Let’s say you turn on your toaster, which has a resistance of 14.4 ohms. How much energy (in watts) does it change from electrical energy to heat? We know that $I = V/R$ and that watts of power are IV . So, given a voltage of V , the toaster is consuming V^2/R watts.

However, V is fluctuating. Let’s plot the power the toaster is consuming:

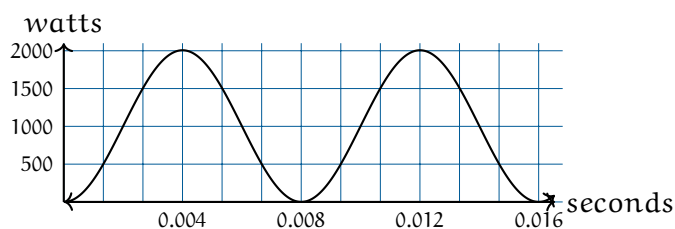


Figure 2.2: A plot of AC power over time.

Another sine wave! Here is a lesser-known trig identity: $(\sin(x))^2 = \frac{1}{2} - \frac{1}{2} \cos(2x)$

This is actually a cosine wave flipped upside down, scaled down by half the peak power, and translated up so that it is never negative. Note that it is also twice the frequency of the voltage sine wave.

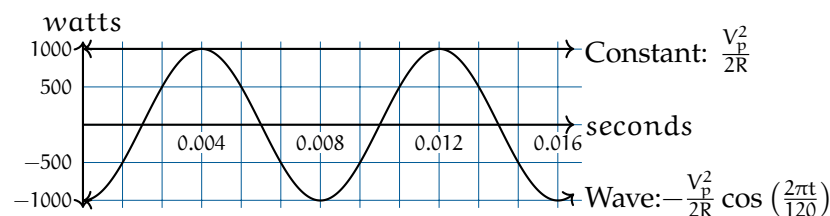
If we say the peak voltage is V_p and the resistance of the toaster is R , the power is given by

$$\frac{V_p^2}{2R} - \frac{V_p^2}{2R} \cos\left(\frac{2\pi t}{120}\right)$$

As a toaster user and as someone who pays a power bill, you are mostly interested in the average power. To get the average power, you take the area under the power graph and divide it by the amount of time.

We can think of the area under the curve as two easy-to-integrate quantities summed:

- A constant function of $y = \frac{V_p^2}{2R}$
- A wave $y = -\frac{V_p^2}{2R} \cos\left(\frac{2\pi t}{120}\right)$



When we integrate that constant function, we get $\frac{tV_p^2}{2R}$.

When we integrate that wave for a complete cycle we get...zero! The positive side of the wave is canceled out by the negative side.

So, the average power is $\frac{V_p^2}{2R}$ watts.

Someone at some point said, “I’m used to power being V^2/R . Can we define a voltage measure for AC power such that this is always true?”

So we started using V_{rms} which is just $\frac{V_p}{\sqrt{2}}$. If you look on the back of anything that plugs into a standard US power outlet, it will say something like “For 120v”. What they mean is, “For 120v RMS, we expect the voltage to fluctuate back and forth from 170v to -170v.”

Notice that this is the same Root-Mean-Squared that we defined earlier, but now we know that if $y = \sin(x)$, the RMS of y is $1/\sqrt{2} \approx 0.707$.

For current, we do the same thing. If the current is AC, the power consumed by a resistor is $I_{\text{RMS}}^2 R$, where I_{RMS} is the peak current divided by $\sqrt{2}$.

2.2 Power Line Losses

A wire has some resistance. Thinner wires tend to have more resistance than thicker ones. Aluminum wires tend to have more resistance than copper wires.

Let’s say that the power that comes to your house has to travel 20 km from the generator in a cable that has about 1Ω of resistance per km. Let’s also say that your home is consuming 12 kilowatts of power. If that power is 120v RMS from the generator to your home, what percentage of the power is lost heating the power line?

10 amps RMS flow through your home. When that current goes through the wire, $I^2 R = (10)(20) = 200$ watts is lost to heat. This means the power company would need to supply 12.2 kilowatts of power, knowing that 200 watts would be lost on the wires.

What if the power company moved the power at 120,000 volts RMS? Now only 0.01 amps RMS flow through your home. When that current goes through the wire $I^2 R = (0.0001)(20) = .002$ watts of power are lost on the power lines.

This is much, much more efficient. The only problem is that 120,000 volts would be incredibly dangerous. So the power company moves power long distances at very high voltages, like 765 kV. Before the power is brought into your home, it is converted into a lower voltage using a *transformer*.

2.3 Transformers

A transformer is a device that converts electrical power from one voltage to another. A good transformer is more than 95% efficient. The details of magnetic fields, flux, and inductance are beyond the scope of this chapter, so we are going to give a relatively

simple (and admittedly incomplete) explanation for now.

A transformer is a ring with two sets of coils wrapped around it.

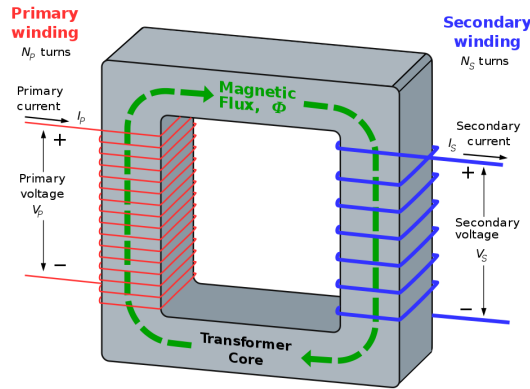


Figure 2.3: A diagram of a transformer from Wikipedia.

When alternating current is run through the primary winding, it creates magnetic flux in the ring. The magnetic flux induces current in the secondary winding. (This is called *induction*.)

If V_P is the voltage across the primary winding and V_S is the voltage across the secondary winding, they are related by the following equation:

$$\frac{V_P}{V_S} = \frac{N_P}{N_S}$$

where N_P and N_S are the number of turns in the primary and secondary windings.

There are usually at least two transformers between you and the very high voltage lines. There are transformers at the substation that make the voltage low enough to travel on regular utility poles. On the utility poles, you will see cans that contain smaller transformers. Those step the voltage down to the 120V RMS that your home uses.

2.4 Phase and 3-phase power

If two waves are “in sync”, we say they have the same *phase*.

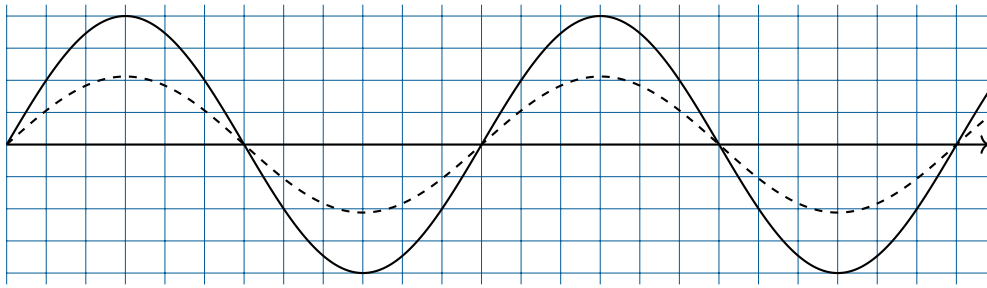


Figure 2.4: A diagram of two AC signals in sync.

If they are the same frequency, but are not in sync, we can talk about the difference in their phase.

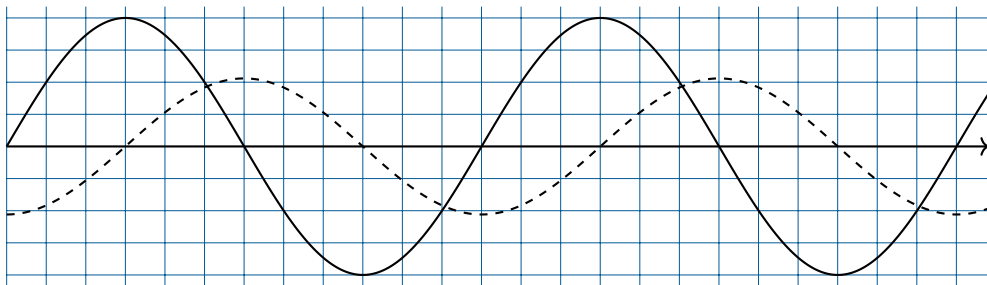
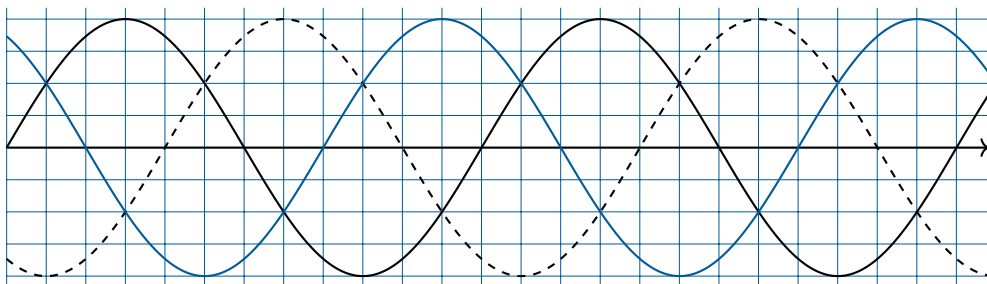


Figure 2.5: A diagram of two AC signals out of phase.

Here, we see that the smaller wave is lagging by $\pi/2$ or 90° .

In most power grids, there are usually three wires carrying the power. The voltage on each is $2\pi/3$ out of phase with the other two:

Figure 2.6: A diagram of three AC signals, each $2\pi/3$ radians out of phase.

This is nice in two ways:

- While the power in each wire is fluctuating, the total power is not fluctuating at all.

- While the power plant is pushing and pulling electrons on each wire, the total number of electrons leaving the load is zero.

(Both these assume that each wire is attached to a load with the same constant resistance.)

In big industrial factories, you will see all three wires enter the building. Large amounts of smooth power delivery means a great deal to an industrial user.

In residential settings, each home gets its power from one of the three wires. However, two wires typically carry power into the home. Each one carries 120V RMS, but they are out of phase by 180 degrees. Lights and small appliances are connected to one of the wires and ground, so they get 120V RMS. Large appliances, like air conditioners and washing machines, are connected across the two wires, so they get 240V RMS.

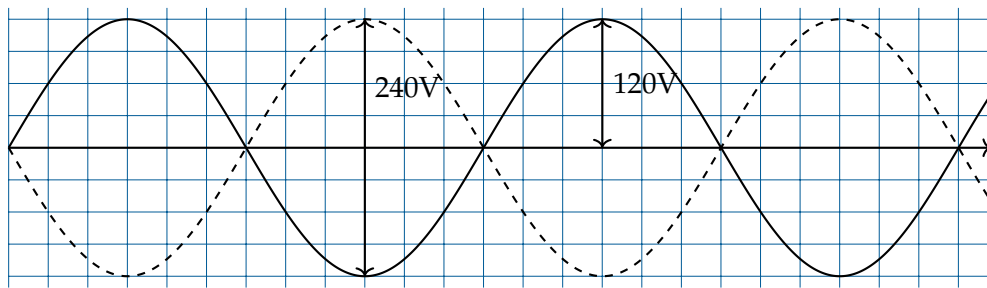


Figure 2.7: A diagram of AC out of phase in homes.

How do you get two circuits, 180 degrees out of phase, from one circuit? Using a center-tap transformer.

FIXME: Diagram here

Electromagnetic Induction

Electromagnetic induction is a fundamental concept in physics that describes how a changing magnetic field can produce an electric current. The phenomenon was discovered by Michael Faraday in 1831 and is the principle behind many electrical devices, including generators and transformers.

3.1 Faraday's Law of Induction

It is important to note that induction is the process of generating a current in a conductor by **changing** the magnetic field around it. In other words, if a conductor is moving through a **constant** magnetic field, no current will be induced. However, if the magnetic field is changing or if the conductor is moving through a gradient, a current will be induced.

The equation that describes electromagnetic induction is known as *Faraday's Law of Induction*:

$$\mathcal{E} = -\frac{d\Phi_B}{dt}$$

where $\mathcal{E}$ is the induced electromotive force (emf) in volts, and Φ_B is the magnetic flux through the circuit in webers (Wb). The negative sign indicates the direction of the induced emf, as described by Lenz's Law. Note that the induced emf is proportional to the **rate of change** of the magnetic flux. This means that a faster change in the magnetic field will result in a larger induced emf.

3.1.1 Magnetic Flux

Magnetic flux (Φ_B) through a surface is defined as:

$$\Phi_B = \int \vec{B} \cdot d\vec{A}$$

where $\vec{B}$ is the magnetic field and $d\vec{A}$ is an infinitesimal area vector perpendicular to the surface. You'll learn more about vector calculus in later workbooks.

3.2 Lenz's Law

Lenz's Law gives the direction of the induced current. It states that the induced current will flow in such a way that its magnetic field opposes the change in magnetic flux that produced it. This is reflected in the negative sign in Faraday's Law.

3.3 Induction in a Coil

When a coil of wire is placed in a region where the magnetic field changes over time, an emf is induced in the coil according to Faraday's Law. If the coil has N turns, the total induced emf is given by:

$$\mathcal{E} = -N \frac{d\Phi_B}{dt}$$

This means that the induced emf is proportional to both the number of turns in the coil and the rate of change of the magnetic flux through each turn.

If the magnetic field changes uniformly and the area of the coil is constant, the change in flux can be written as:

$$\Delta\Phi_B = \Delta B \times A$$

where A is the area of the coil and ΔB is the change in magnetic field.

Therefore, the induced emf for a coil experiencing a uniform change in magnetic field is:

$$\mathcal{E} = -N \frac{A\Delta B}{\Delta t}$$

This principle is widely used in devices such as electric generators, where coils rotate in a magnetic field to produce electricity.

Exercise 8 Induced EMF in a Coil

A coil with 100 turns and area 0.2 m^2 experiences a change in magnetic field from 0 to 5 T over 0.1 s. Calculate the induced emf.

Working Space

Answer on Page 84

3.4 Applications of Electromagnetic Induction

- **Electric Generators:** Convert mechanical energy into electrical energy using electromagnetic induction.
- **Transformers:** Change the voltage of alternating current (AC) electricity using induction between coils.
- **Induction Cooktops:** Use rapidly changing magnetic fields to heat cookware directly.

Electric Motor

Electric motors are devices that convert electrical energy into mechanical energy. They operate based on the interaction between magnetic fields and electric currents, producing rotational motion. As mentioned previously, when an electric current flows through a conductor, it generates a magnetic field around the conductor. If you place a magnet near this conductor, the magnetic field will interact with the magnet's field, causing the conductor to experience a force. This force can be harnessed to create motion, which is the fundamental principle behind electric motors.

4.1 Basic Electric Motor

The most common type of electric motor is the DC (Direct Current) brushed motor. It consists of a coil of wire (armature) that rotates within a magnetic field created by permanent magnets or electromagnets. The armature is connected to a commutator, which reverses the direction of the current in the coil as it rotates, ensuring continuous rotation in one direction. The name "brushed" refers to the use of brushes that make contact with the commutator to supply current to the armature.

TODO: Can there be a graphic of a basic electric motor? The generator image is similar, but the motor has a power source rather than a load.

Other types of electric motors include brushless DC motors, stepper motors, and AC (Alternating Current) motors. Each type has its own characteristics and applications, but they all operate on the same basic principles of electromagnetism.

4.2 Basic Electric Generator

Electric generators are the reverse of electric motors. They convert mechanical energy into electrical energy by using the principle of *electromagnetic induction*. When a conductor (such as a coil of wire) moves through a magnetic field, it induces an electric current in the conductor. This is covered in another chapter.

To construct a basic electric generator, all you need is an electric motor and a load.

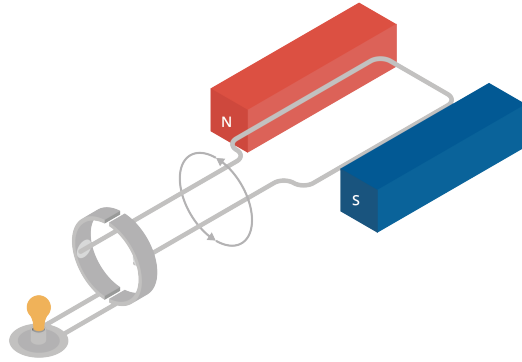


Figure 4.1: Basic Electric Generator Diagram

When you turn the motor with mechanical force, it will generate electricity that can be used to power a load. As the coil rotates within the magnetic field, the changing magnetic field induces a current in the coil, which can flow through the load, providing the necessary power.

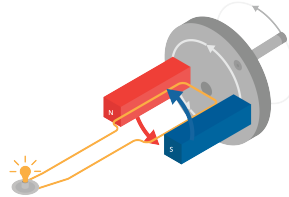


Figure 4.2: Basic Electric Generator in Motion with Handcrank

If you instead turn the motor with a wheel, you can generate electricity in any manner of ways. This simple principle is used all over the world to generate electricity. For example, in hydroelectric power plants, water is used to turn large turbines connected to generators, producing electricity on a massive scale. In wind power plants, wind turns the blades of a turbine, which is connected to a generator that produces electricity. In coal and natural gas power plants, steam is used to turn turbines connected to generators.

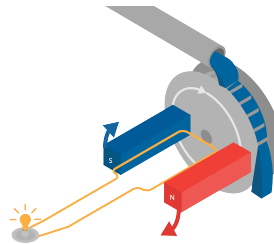


Figure 4.3: Basic Electric Generator in Motion with Wheel

Drag

The very first computers were created to do calculations of how artillery would fly when shot at different angles. The calculations were similar to the ones you did earlier for the flying hammer, with two important differences:

- They were interested in two dimensions: the height and the distance across the ground.
- However, artillery flies a lot faster than a hammer, so they also had to worry about drag from the air.

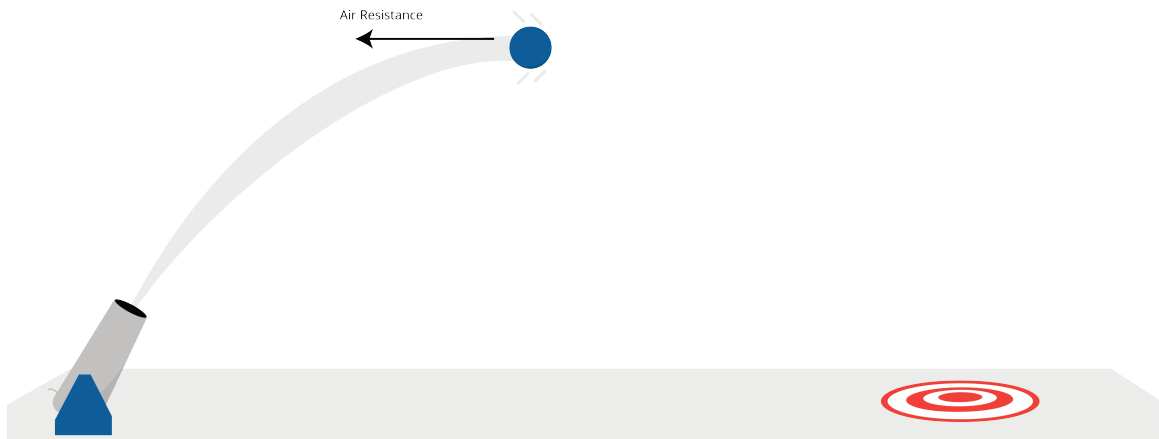


Figure 5.1: A cannonball shot has a parabolic trajectory.

5.1 Wind resistance

The first thing they did was put one of the shells in a wind tunnel. They measured how much force was created when they pushed 1 m/s of wind over the shell. Let's say it was 0.1 newtons.

One of the interesting things about the drag from the air (often called *wind resistance*) is

that it increases with the *square* of the speed. Thus, if the wind pushing on the shell is 3 m/s, instead of 1 m/s, the resistance is $3^2 \times 0.1 = 0.9$ newtons.

(Why? Intuitively, three times as many air molecules are hitting the shell and each molecule is hitting it three times harder.)

So, if a shell is moving with the velocity vector v , the force vector of the drag points in the exact opposite direction. If μ is the force of wind resistance of the shell at 1 m/s, then the magnitude of the drag vector is $\mu|v|^2$ with μ being the wind resistance force.

5.2 Initial velocity and acceleration due to gravity

Let's say a shell is shot out of a tube at s m/s, and the tube is tilted θ radians above level. The initial velocity will be given by the vector $[s \cos(\theta), s \sin(\theta)]$

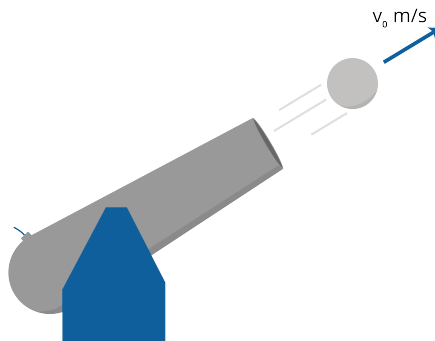


Figure 5.2: The initial velocity vector of the shell.

(The velocity of the shell is actually a 3-dimensional vector, but we are only going to worry about height and horizontal distance; we are assuming that the operator pointed it in the right direction.)

To figure out the path of the shell, we need to compute its acceleration. We remember that

$$F = ma$$

(Note that F and a are vectors.) Dividing both sides by m , we get:

$$a = \frac{F}{m}$$

Let's figure out the net force on the shell, so that we can calculate the acceleration vector.

If the shell has a mass of b , the force due to gravity will be in the downward direction, with a magnitude of $9.8b$ newtons.

To get the net force, we will need to add the force due to gravity with the force due to wind resistance.

5.3 Simulating artillery in Python

Create a file called `artillery.py`.

```

1  import numpy as np
2      import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
3
4      # Constants
5      mass = 45 # kg
6      start_speed = 300.0 # m/s
7      theta = np.pi/5 # radians (36 degrees above level)
8      time_step = 0.01 # s
9      wind_resistance = 0.05 # newtons in 1 m/s wind
10     force_of_gravity = np.array([0.0, -9.8 * mass]) # newtons
11
12     # Initial state
13     position = np.array([0.0, 0.0]) # [distance, height] in meters
14     velocity = np.array([start_speed * np.cos(theta), start_speed *
15         ↪ np.sin(theta)])
16     time = 0.0 # seconds
17
18     # Lists to gather data
19     distances = []
20     heights = []
21     times = []
22
23     # While shell is aloft
24     while position[1] >= 0:
25         # Record data
26         distances.append(position[0])
27         heights.append(position[1])
28         times.append(time)
29
30         # Calculate the next state
31         time += time_step
32         position += time_step * velocity

```

```

32
33     # Calculate the net force vector
34     force = force_of_gravity - wind_resistance * velocity**2
35
36     # Calculate the current acceleration vector
37     acceleration = force / mass
38
39     # Update the velocity vector
40     velocity += time_step * acceleration
41
42     print(f"Hit the ground {position[0]:.2f} meters away at {time:.2f} seconds.")
43
44     # Plot the data
45     fig, ax = plt.subplots()
46     ax.plot(distances, heights)
47     ax.set_title("Distance vs. Height")
48     ax.set_xlabel("Distance (m)")
49     ax.set_ylabel("Height (m)")
50     plt.show()

```

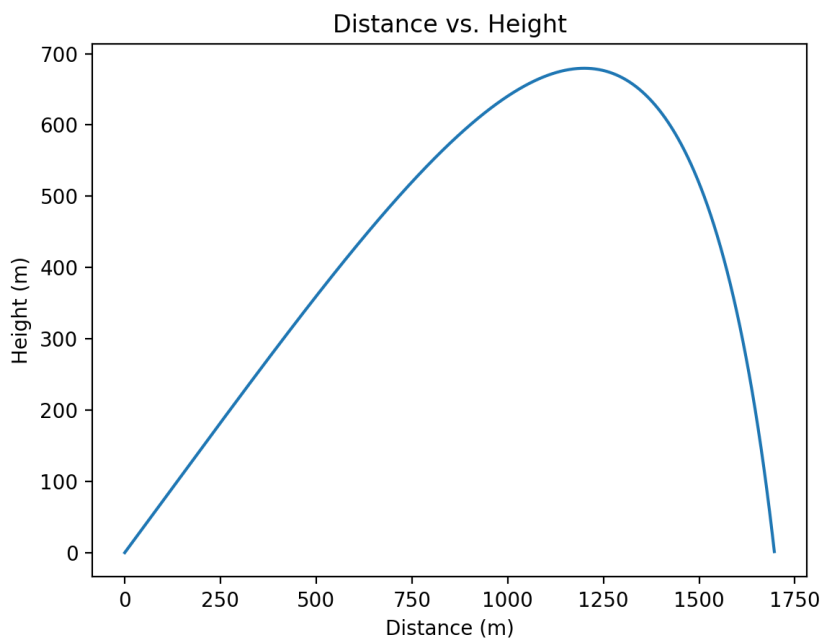
When you run it, you should get a message like:

```

1 Hit the ground 1696.70 meters away at 20.73 seconds.

```

You should also see a plot of the shell's path:



5.4 Terminal velocity

If you shot the shell very, very high in the sky, it would keep accelerating toward the ground until the force of gravity and the force of the wind resistance were equal. The speed at which this happens is called the *terminal velocity*. The terminal velocity of a falling human is about 53 m/s.

Note that kinematic equations do not apply to terminal velocity, because the acceleration is not constant. Instead, we can use the fact that at terminal velocity, the force of wind resistance equals the force of gravity.

Exercise 9 Terminal velocity

What is the terminal velocity of the shell described in our example?

Working Space

Answer on Page 85

Parametric Functions

Throughout your study of functions, you have seen functions that look like this:

$$y = f(x)$$

Sometimes, to describe certain shapes or curves on a graph, we must use more than one function to do so. This means a shape, like a circle on the graph, can be represented using

$$y = f(t) \quad \text{and} \quad x = g(t).$$

In this case, there are two functions, $x(t)$ and $y(t)$, that depend on a third variable t , and together they help us visualize and define a curve.

The central word you should think about as you go through this chapter is *parameter*. A parameter is a variable that both x and y depend on. The most common example of a parametric function is the circle. To represent a circle on a graph, we can use the equations

$$x = \cos(\theta) \quad \text{and} \quad y = \sin(\theta).$$

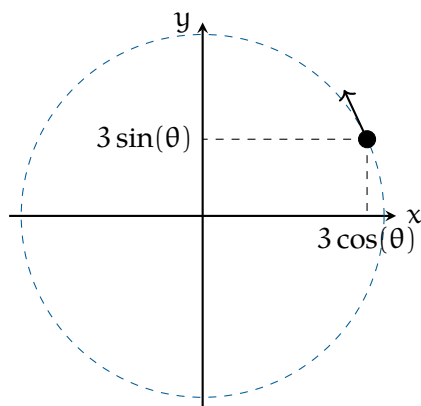


Figure 6.1: A diagram of a circle formed through a parametric functions.

In this case, the graph of the circle is determined by the value of the angle θ , the parameter.

So, why parametric functions? When you look up the function that describes a circle, you might see something like

$$x^2 + y^2 = r^2.$$

The equation $x^2 + y^2 = r^2$ does not describe y as a single function of x . You would need two functions (one for the top half and one for the bottom half), and many curves cannot be written as a single function at all. Parametric equations solve this problem by allowing us to describe the en-

tire curve with one pair of equations, using a parameter t . This parameter can be denoted by other letters, but we will use t in this chapter.

Imagine a ball rolling across graph paper. At each moment, the ball is at a different location. If we label time with a variable t , then for every value of t the ball has an x -coordinate and a y -coordinate. What if we had two equations, one that told us its x -position at time t and one that told us its y -position? As t changes, these two equations would trace the entire path of the ball. This is the basic idea behind parametric equations.

6.1 Conversion to Rectangular Form

In many cases, we can eliminate the parameter to convert a pair of parametric equations,

$$x = f(t), \quad y = g(t),$$

into a single equation relating x and y .

In many cases, a parametric curve can be rewritten as a single equation involving only x and y . This process is called eliminating the parameter, and the resulting equation is known as the rectangular form of the curve.

To eliminate the parameter, we solve one of the parametric equations for t and substitute into the other equation.

Example:

Consider the parametric equations

$$x = 2t + 1, \quad y = 3t - 4.$$

Solution: Solve the equation for x to isolate t :

$$t = \frac{x - 1}{2}.$$

Substitute into the equation for y :

$$y = 3 \left(\frac{x - 1}{2} \right) - 4.$$

Simplifying,

$$y = \frac{3}{2}x - \frac{11}{2}.$$

Example

Consider the parametric equations

$$x = \cos t, \quad y = \sin t.$$

Solution: In this case, solving for t directly is not convenient. Instead, we use the trigonometric identity

$$\cos^2 t + \sin^2 t = 1.$$

Substituting $x = \cos t$ and $y = \sin t$ gives

$$x^2 + y^2 = 1.$$

This rectangular equation describes a circle of radius 1 centered at the origin.

Note

Converting to rectangular form describes the shape of a curve, but it does not show the direction of motion or how many times the curve is traced. This information is contained in the parametric equations and the domain of the parameter!

6.2 Sketching Parametric Equations

Parametric equations describe curves by expressing both x and y in terms of a third variable, usually t , called the parameter. When sketching a parametric curve, it is important to remember that the curve is traced as the parameter changes, rather than being drawn all at once as a function of x .

To sketch a parametric curve,

- choose several values of the parameter t ,
- compute the corresponding x - and y -values,
- plot the resulting points in the xy -plane,
- and indicate the direction in which the curve is traced as t increases.

Unlike rectangular graphs, parametric sketches also depend on the direction and speed of motion, which are determined by how $x(t)$ and $y(t)$ change as t varies.

FIXME Sketched example

Exercise 10

Working Space

Sketch the parametric equations

$$x = t + 1, \quad y = t^2.$$

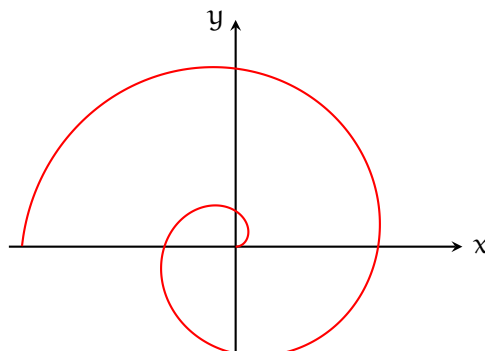
In your sketch:

- create a table of values for t , x , and y ,
- plot the corresponding points,
- and indicate the direction of motion as t increases.

Answer on Page 85

Here is an example of an Archimedean Spiral, a spiral where the radius r is proportional to the angle θ . In parametric form, it is represented as

$$x(t) = t \cos(t), \quad y(t) = t \sin(t)$$



6.3 Using Python to Explore Parametric Curves

Python can be used to visualize parametric curves and explore how the point $(x(t), y(t))$ moves as t changes. For example, we could write code that:

- plots points along a circle defined by $x = \cos(t)$ and $y = \sin(t)$,
- shows the distance from the origin,
- traces more complicated parametric curves like spirals or ellipses.

Below is a Python script that creates an animation for sketching parametric curves. There is a provision for changing the equations based on exercises and questions you come across.

```
1  import numpy as np
2  import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
3  from matplotlib.animation import FuncAnimation
4
5  t = np.linspace(0, 3, 50)
6
7  x = 4 - 2*t
8  y = 3 + 6*t - 4*t**2
9
10 fig, ax = plt.subplots()
11 ax.set_aspect("equal", "box")
12
13 ax.axhline(0, color="black", linewidth=0.5)
14 ax.axvline(0, color="black", linewidth=0.5)
15
16 ax.set_xlabel("x(t)")
17 ax.set_ylabel("y(t)")
18 ax.set_title("Parametric Equation of Curve")
19
20 ax.set_xlim([x.min() - 1, x.max() + 1])
21 ax.set_ylim([y.min() - 1, y.max() + 1])
22
23 (line,) = ax.plot([], [], "b--")
24 (point,) = ax.plot([], [], "ro")
25
26 def update(frame):
27     line.set_data(x[:frame + 1], y[:frame + 1])
28     point.set_data([x[frame]], [y[frame]])
29     return line, point
```

```
30  
31 ani = FuncAnimation(fig, update, frames=len(t), interval=50, blit=True)  
32 ani.save("parametric_animation.mp4")  
33  
34 plt.show()
```


Exercise 11*Working Space*

Consider the parametric equations

$$x = 4 - 2t, \quad y = 3 + 6t - 4t^2,$$

for $0 \leq t \leq 3$.

- (a) Sketch the curve by creating a table of values for t , x , and y .
- (b) Use the provided Python animation code to visualize the curve.
- (c) Describe the direction in which the curve is traced as t increases.
- (d) Explain how the Python animation supports or clarifies your hand-drawn sketch.

Answer on Page 85

6.4 Derivatives of Parametric Functions

Just like any other type of curve, you can be asked to determine the slope of the tangent to the point on a parametric curve. To do this, you should know how to find the derivative of the curve! You could do this by eliminating the variable t and solving for the derivative of the rectangular equation. However, there is an easier way!

The derivative of a parametric curve can be found by dividing $\frac{dy}{dt}$ by $\frac{dx}{dt}$:

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{dy/dt}{dx/dt}.$$

Derivatives of parametric functions are used to describe the slope of a curve at a given value of the parameter. This slope indicates how the curve is changing at that point. In some problems, the slope is used to find the equation of a tangent line to the curve. In other problems, the slope is used to analyze the behavior of the curve, such as determining where the curve has horizontal or vertical tangents.

Example

Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ for the parametric equations

$$x = t^2 + 1, \quad y = 3t - 2.$$

Solution

First compute the derivatives with respect to t :

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = 2t, \quad \frac{dy}{dt} = 3.$$

Now divide:

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{3}{2t}.$$

As a check, eliminate the parameter. From $x = t^2 + 1$, we get

$$t = \sqrt{x-1}.$$

Substitute into $y = 3t - 2$:

$$y = 3\sqrt{x-1} - 2.$$

Differentiating gives

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{3}{2\sqrt{x-1}},$$

which matches the parametric result.

Exercise 12

Working Space

Consider the parametric equations

$$x = t^3 - 3t, \quad y = t^2.$$

- (a) Compute $\frac{dx}{dt}$ and $\frac{dy}{dt}$.
- (b) Find the values of t for which the curve has horizontal tangents.
- (c) Find the values of t for which the curve has vertical tangents.
- (d) Identify the points on the curve where these tangents occur.

Answer on Page 86

Exercise 13*Working Space*

Consider the parametric equations

$$x = 2t + 1, \quad y = t^2.$$

- (a) Find $\frac{dy}{dx}$ in terms of t .
- (b) Evaluate $\frac{dy}{dx}$ at $t = 1$.
- (c) Interpret your result as the slope of the tangent line at the corresponding point.

Answer on Page 87

6.5 Length of Curve Traced by Parametric Equations

In the Python animation, a point moves along the curve as the parameter t increases. This animation highlights an important idea: parametric equations do not only describe the shape of a curve, they describe motion along that curve.

At each moment in time, the point is located at $(x(t), y(t))$. As t changes, the point moves from one position to the next. Sometimes this movement covers a small distance, and sometimes it covers a larger distance, even though the point remains on the same curve. This means the point does not necessarily move at a constant rate.

Speed measures how fast the point is moving along the curve at a given value of t . Once the speed is known, we can determine how far the point travels over a time interval. The length of the curve traced by the parametric equations is the total distance traveled by the moving point.

Speed of a Parametric Curve

When a point moves along a parametric curve, its velocity is determined by the derivatives $x'(t)$ and $y'(t)$. The speed of the point is the magnitude of the velocity vector:

$$\text{Speed} = \sqrt{(x'(t))^2 + (y'(t))^2}.$$

Speed describes how fast the point is moving at a particular moment, but it does not tell us the total distance traveled along the curve.

Arc Length Formula

To find the length of the curve traced by a parametric equation from $t = a$ to $t = b$, we integrate the speed over that interval.

If a curve is defined parametrically by $x = x(t)$ and $y = y(t)$, where $x'(t)$ and $y'(t)$ are continuous on $[a, b]$, then the length of the curve is given by

$$L = \int_a^b \sqrt{(x'(t))^2 + (y'(t))^2} dt.$$

Example: Finding Speed

Given

$$x'(t) = 8t - t^2, \quad y'(t) = -t + \sqrt{t^{1.2} + 20},$$

the speed of the particle at time t is

$$\text{Speed} = \sqrt{(8t - t^2)^2 + \left(-t + \sqrt{t^{1.2} + 20}\right)^2}.$$

Evaluating at $t = 2$ gives a speed of approximately 12.3 cm/s.

Example: Length of a Curve

Consider the parametric equations

$$x = \cos t, \quad y = \sin t,$$

for $0 \leq t \leq 2\pi$.

First compute the derivatives:

$$x'(t) = -\sin t, \quad y'(t) = \cos t.$$

Substitute into the arc length formula:

$$L = \int_0^{2\pi} \sqrt{(-\sin t)^2 + (\cos t)^2} dt.$$

Using the identity $\sin^2 t + \cos^2 t = 1$, this simplifies to

$$L = \int_0^{2\pi} 1 dt = 2\pi.$$

Thus, the length of the curve traced is 2π , which matches the circumference of the unit circle.

Note

Speed describes how fast a point moves along a parametric curve at a given moment. Arc length measures the total distance traveled along the curve over an interval of time. For

parametric curves, arc length is found by integrating the speed.

Exercise 14

How can two sets of parametric equations represent the same graph, but different curves?

Working Space

Answer on Page 87

Vector-valued Functions

In the last chapter, you calculated the flight of the shell. For any time t , you could find a vector [distance, height]. This can be thought of as a function f that takes a number and returns a 2-dimensional vector. We call this a *vector-valued* function from $\mathbb{R} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2 \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^3$ ¹.

7.1 Vector-valued functions: position

We often make a vector-valued function by defining several real-valued functions. For example, if you threw a hammer with an initial upward speed of 12 m/s and a horizontal speed of 4 m/s along the x axis from the point $(1, 6, 2)$, its position at time t (during its flight) would be given by:

$$f(t) = [4t + 1, 6, -4.8t^2 + 12t + 2]$$

In other words, x is increasing with t , y is constant, and z is a parabola.

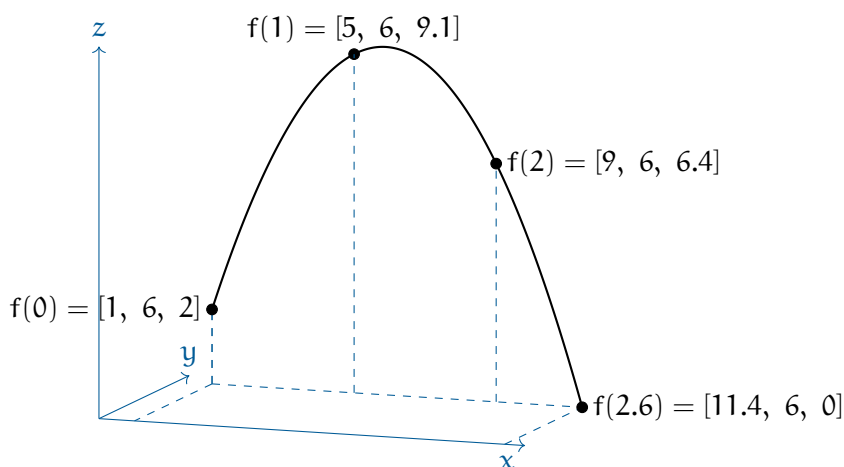


Figure 7.1: An example of a vector-valued function.

¹the $\mathbb{R}$ symbol represents the set of all real numbers; the $\mathbb{R}^2$ symbol represents the set of all 2-dimensional vectors, and $\mathbb{R}^3$ represents the set of all 3-dimensional vectors

7.2 Finding the velocity vector

Now that we have its position vector, we can differentiate each component separately to get its velocity as a vector-valued function:

$$f'(t) = [4, 0, -9.8t + 12]$$

In other words, the velocity is constant along the x -axis, zero along the y -axis, and decreasing with time along the z axis.

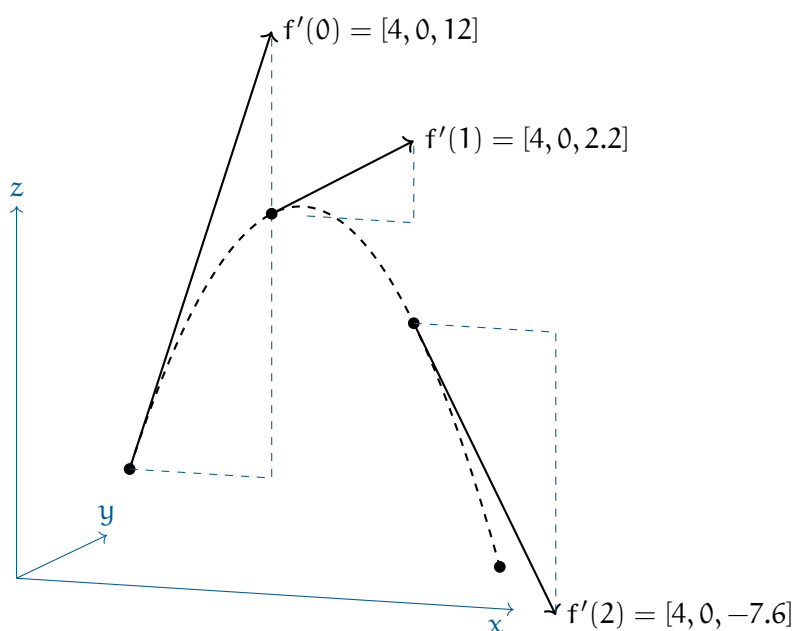


Figure 7.2: The derivatives of the position function (velocity) with respect to time.

7.3 Finding the acceleration vector

Now that we have its velocity, we can get its acceleration as a vector-valued function:

$$f''(t) = [0, 0, -9.8]$$

There is no acceleration along the x or y axes. It is accelerating down at a constant 9.8m/s^2 .

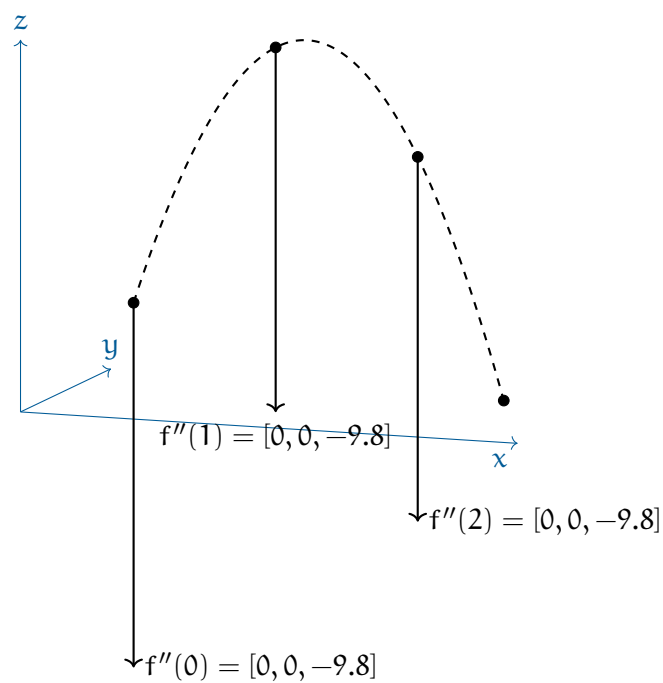


Figure 7.3: The acceleration vector is constant and points downward.

Circular Motion

We can recall the motion of 2D objects, such as a projectile launched or a car driving along a road. They have components of linear motion, such as position, velocity, acceleration, and force.

But that only works for objects moving in a straight line. What about objects moving in a circle?

8.1 Introduction to Uniform Circular Motion

Recall that in linear motion, You may be surprised to know that we can use very similar equations to describe circular motion, provided you use the correct variables.

The angular displacement, θ , is the angle in *radians* that the object has traveled. The angular velocity, ω , is the rate of change of the angular displacement, and the angular acceleration, α , is the rate of change of the angular velocity.

Linear motion	Rotational motion
$v = v_0 + at$	$\omega = \omega_0 + \alpha t$
$x = x_0 + v_0 t + \frac{1}{2}at^2$	$\theta = \theta_0 + \omega_0 t + \frac{1}{2}\alpha t^2$
$v^2 = v_0^2 + 2a(x - x_0)$	$\omega^2 = \omega_0^2 + 2\alpha(\theta - \theta_0)$

Table 8.1: Kinematic equations for linear and rotational motion.

Linear velocity, v , is related to angular velocity by the equation:

$$v = r\omega$$

The *Period*, T , is the time it takes to complete one full rotation. The frequency, f , is the number of rotations per second. The two are related by:

$$T = \frac{2\pi}{\omega} = \frac{2\pi r}{v}$$

$$f = \frac{1}{T}$$

The *centripetal force*, usually labelled differently (such as tension or gravity), is given by

the equation:

$$F = mr\omega^2 = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

The *angular velocity*, ω is rotations with respect to time. It can be defined in the following ways:

$$\omega_{\text{inst}} = \frac{d\theta}{dt}, \quad \omega_{\text{avg}} = \frac{\Delta\theta}{\Delta t}$$

$$\omega = 2\pi f = \frac{2\pi}{T}$$

Angular acceleration:

$$\alpha = \frac{d\omega}{dt}, \quad \alpha_{\text{avg}} = \frac{\Delta\omega}{\Delta t}$$

Note that all of the kinematic formulas still work as long as you stay in the same relative frame of reference (rotational or linear). You cannot “mix and match” the two sets of equations.

You may be asking, “If the object is moving at a constant speed, why is there acceleration?” Recall that acceleration is a vector quantity, meaning it has both magnitude and direction. Even though the speed (the magnitude of the velocity) is constant, the direction of the velocity vector is always changing. Since acceleration is the rate of change of velocity, any change in direction means there is acceleration. This acceleration is always directed toward the center of the circle, which is why it is called centripetal (center-seeking) acceleration.

Now that we’ve established the basic relationships for circular motion, let’s apply them to a practical example.

8.2 The Flying Billiard Ball

Let’s say you tie a 0.16 kg billiard ball to a long string and begin to swing it around in a circle above your head. The string, perpendicular, is 3 meters long, and the ball returns to where it started every 4 seconds. We will assume the ball moves at a constant speed. If you start your stopwatch as the ball crosses the x -axis, the coordinates of the position (x, y, z) of the ball at any time t given by:

$$p(t) = \left[3 \cos\left(\frac{2\pi}{4}t\right), 3 \sin\left(\frac{2\pi}{4}t\right), 2 \right]$$

(This assumes that the ball would be going counter-clockwise if viewed from above. The

spot you are standing on is considered the origin $[0, 0, 0]$.)

Notice that the height is a constant — 2 meters in this case. That isn't very interesting, so we will talk just about the first two components. Figure 8.1 shows a visual of the situation:

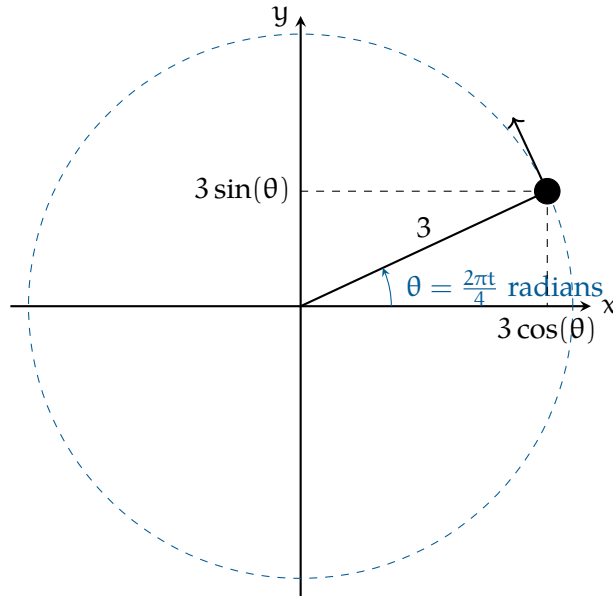


Figure 8.1: A diagram of our ball and string scenario.

In this case, the radius, r , is 3 meters. The period, T , is 4 seconds. In general, we say that circular motion is given by:

$$p(t) = \left[r \cos \frac{2\pi t}{T}, r \sin \frac{2\pi t}{T} \right]$$

A common question is “How fast is it turning right now?” If you divide the 2π radians of a circle by the 4 seconds it takes, you get the answer “About 1.57 radians per second.” This is known as *angular velocity* and we typically represent it with the lowercase Omega: ω . (Yes, it looks a lot like a “w”.) To be precise, in our example, the angular velocity is $\omega = \frac{\pi}{2}$. Note that in this scenario, the angular velocity and linear *speed* are constant. However, the *velocity* vector is not constant; as we will see in the next section, the direction of the velocity vector is always changing.

Notice that this is different from the question “How fast is it going? (referring to *linear velocity*)” This ball is traveling the circumference of $6\pi \approx 18.85$ meters every 4 seconds. This means the speed of the ball is about 4.71 meters per second.

It is very important to distinguish between angular velocity and linear velocity. Angular

velocity is how fast the angle is changing and is referred to by ω , while linear velocity, v , is how fast the object is moving along its path. While linear velocity has a constant speed, it has always changing direction. The angular velocity is constant, but the linear velocity is not.

8.3 Velocity

The velocity of the ball is a vector, and we can find that vector by differentiating each component of the position vector.

For any constants a and b :

Expression $f(x)$	Derivative $f'(x)$
$a \sin bt$	$ab \cos bt$
$a \cos bt$	$-ab \sin bt$

Thus, in our example, the velocity of the ball at any time t is given by:

$$\mathbf{v}(t) = \left[-\frac{3(2\pi)}{4} \sin \frac{2\pi t}{4}, \frac{3(2\pi)}{4} \cos \frac{2\pi t}{4}, 0 \right]$$

Notice that the velocity vector is perpendicular to the position vector. It has a constant magnitude.

In general, an object traveling in a circle at a constant speed has the velocity vector:

$$\mathbf{v}(t) = [-r\omega \sin \omega t, r\omega \cos \omega t]$$

where $t = 0$ is the time that it crosses the x axis. If ω is negative, that means the motion would be clockwise when viewed from above.

The magnitude of the velocity vector is $r\omega$. See Figure 8.4a for a visual of the velocity vector. Note that the z -coordinate is constant, so its derivative is zero, and it is eliminated from our vector for simplification.

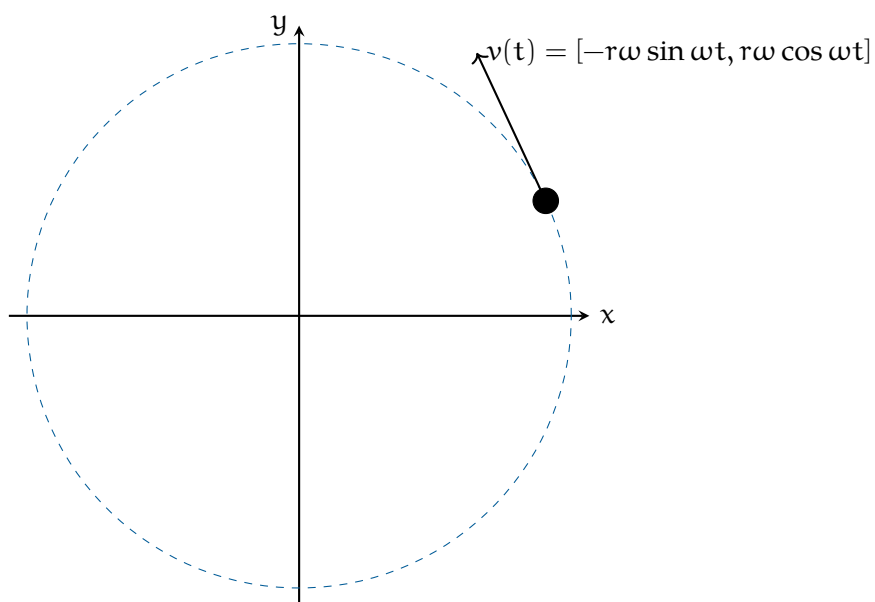


Figure 8.2: Velocity vector of the ball in circular motion.

Exercise 15 A Particle in Motion

[This question was originally presented as two multiple-choice problems on the 2012 AP Physics C exam.] The x and y coordinates of a particle as it moves in a circle are given by:

$$x = 5 \cos(3t) \quad y = 5 \sin(3t)$$

What is the radius of the particle's circular path? What is the particle's *speed*? Based on your answers, how long does it take the particle to complete the circular path?

Working Space

Answer on Page 87

8.4 Acceleration

We can get the (linear) acceleration by differentiating the components of the velocity vector.

$$\mathbf{a}(t) = [-r\omega^2 \cos \omega t, -r\omega^2 \sin \omega t] = -r\omega^2 [\cos \omega t, \sin \omega t]$$

Notice that the acceleration vector points **toward the center** of the circle it is traveling on. That is, when an object is traveling on a circle at a constant (uniform) speed (notice

that coefficients r and ω are constant), its only acceleration is toward the center of the circle. The acceleration does not come from the motion itself, it comes from the constantly changing direction. This is known as *centripetal acceleration*.

The magnitude of the acceleration vector is $a_c = r\omega^2$, or more commonly, $a_c = \frac{v^2}{r}$. This gives us the common calculation for whatever force acts as the centripetal force: $F_c = ma_c = \frac{mv^2}{r}$.¹

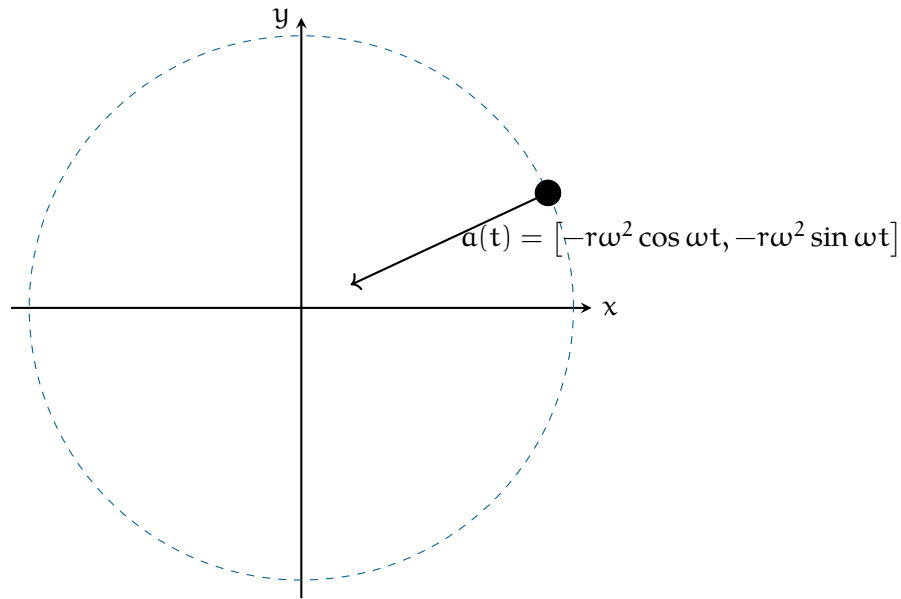


Figure 8.3: Acceleration vector of the particle in circular motion.

Let's compare the velocity and acceleration paths from figures 8.4a and 8.4b. Notice that the velocity vector is always tangent to the circle, while the acceleration vector is always pointing toward the center of the circle.

¹You will see centripetal acceleration noted as a_c or a_r , standing for centripetal or radial, respectively. Note that both refer to the same acceleration.

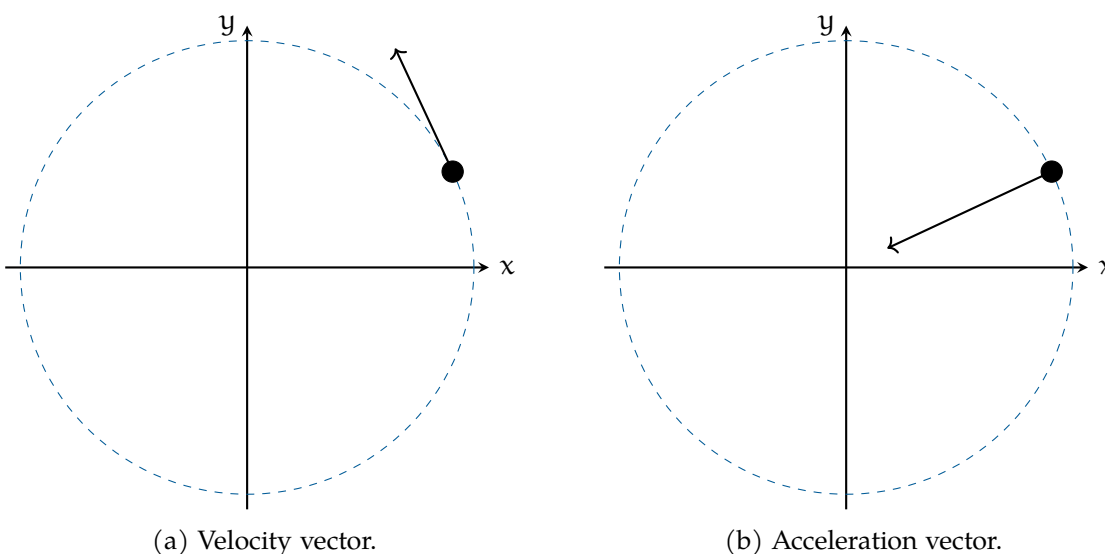


Figure 8.4: Uniform circular motion: velocity (tangent) and acceleration (centripetal).

8.5 Centripetal force

What would happen if there were no force pulling the ball toward the center of the circle? It would fly off in a straight line, according to Newton's First Law.

The force you are exerting on the string is what causes it to accelerate toward the center of the circle. We call this the *centripetal force*. It makes sense that the centripetal force and centripetal acceleration are in the same direction, as they are proportional.

Recall that $F = ma$. The magnitude of the acceleration is $r\omega^2 = 3\left(\frac{2\pi}{4}\right)^2 \approx 7.4\text{m/s}^2$. The mass of the ball is 0.16 kg. So, the force pulling against your hand is about 1.18 newtons.

The general rule is that when something is traveling in a circle at a constant speed, the centripetal force needed to keep it traveling in a circle is:

$$F = mr\omega^2$$

If you know the radius r and the speed v of the object, here is the rule:

$$F = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

We didn't introduce centripetal force as a type of force because it isn't its own force, like friction or gravity. Rather, calling a force "centripetal" tells us what the force is doing. A

centripetal force is any force that causes circular motion, a force which acts in the *radial* direction. For a satellite, the centripetal force is gravity. In the opening example with the billiard ball, the centripetal force is the tension in the string.

Example: A child is sitting on a merry-go-round as it spins. What provides the centripetal force?

Solution: In this case, the child is rotating horizontally, so the centripetal force must also be horizontal. Therefore, the centripetal force isn't the child's weight or the normal force. It is the *friction* between the child and the merry-go-round that keeps the child turning. Here is a free body diagram:

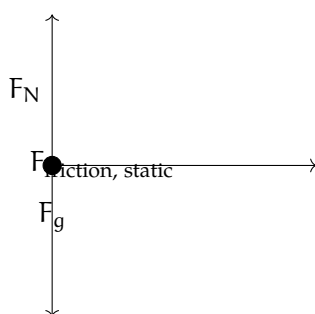


Figure 8.5: The static friction is what causes the centripetal force.

Example: If the child is 1.2 meters from the center of the merry-go-round and it spins at 0.25 rotations/second, what is the coefficient of friction between the child and the merry-go-round?

Solution: Using our FBD and applying Newton's Second Law, we see that:

$$F_N - F_g = 0 \rightarrow F_N = m_{\text{child}}g$$

$$F_f = mr\omega^2 = \mu F_N = \mu mg$$

Since the child isn't accelerating vertically, we know that the normal force equals the child's weight. The horizontal force, friction, must equal the mass of the child times the acceleration. Additionally, from the vertical component, we know the friction is equal to μmg , since the normal force is equal to the child's weight. Looking at the second equation, we see that:

$$mr\omega^2 = \mu mg$$

We were given ω in rotations per second, but we need radians per second:

$$\frac{0.25\text{rotation}}{1\text{second}} = \frac{1\text{rotation}}{4\text{seconds}} = \frac{2\pi\text{radians}}{4\text{seconds}} = \frac{\pi\text{ rad}}{2\text{ s}}$$

We can divide m from both sides of $m r \omega^2 = \mu m g$ (notice: we don't need to know the child's mass to determine the coefficient of friction!):

$$r \omega^2 = \mu g \rightarrow \mu = \frac{r \omega^2}{g} = \frac{(1.2\text{m}) \left(\frac{\pi}{2\text{s}}\right)^2}{9.8 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}^2}} = 0.302$$

Therefore, the coefficient of friction between the child and the merry-go-round is 0.302.

8.5.1 Banked Turns

Have you ever been driving on the highway and taken a turn where the road is at an angle? Or maybe you've seen a sign like Figure 8.6 on the road as you take a turn.

A banked curve is designed so that a car can safely turn without slipping, even in the rain, if the driver does not exceed the indicated speed. Engineers choose an angle such that the bank provides sufficient force to turn the car without friction. Let's look at a free body diagram for a car taking a banked turn (see figure 8.7).



Figure 8.6: A banked turn sign on the highway.

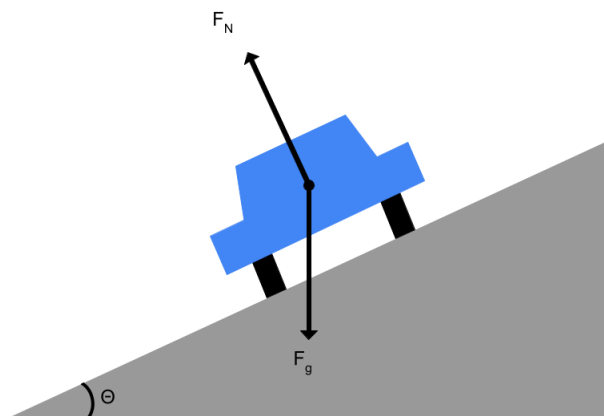


Figure 8.7: If there is no friction due to rain, then the only two forces acting on the car are gravity and the normal force.

In the past, we've split the vector for the force of gravity into components that are parallel and perpendicular to the ramp. This time, we will split the normal force into x and y components (see figure 8.8).

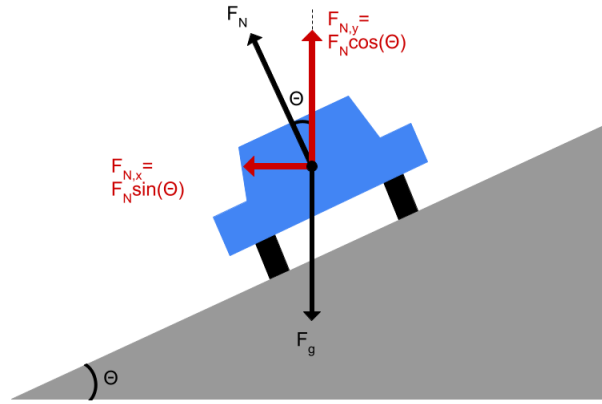


Figure 8.8: Geometrically, the x component of the normal force is given by $F_N \cos(\theta)$ and the y component by $F_N \sin(\theta)$.

Assuming the radius of the turn is 20 m, at what angle should the engineers build the banked turn? (Let's also assume the maximum speed is 25 mph, like the traffic sign above.) First, let's apply Newton's Second Law in the x and y directions:

$$(1) F_N \cos(\theta) - F_g = 0$$

$$(2) F_N \sin(\theta) = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

We know that $F_g = mg$. From this and equation (1) we see that:

$$F_N = \frac{mg}{\cos(\theta)}$$

Substituting for F_N into equation (2):

$$\left(\frac{mg}{\cos(\theta)} \right) \sin(\theta) = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

The mass can be divided from both sides, and $\frac{\sin(\theta)}{\cos(\theta)} = \tan(\theta)$:

$$g \tan(\theta) = \frac{v^2}{r}$$

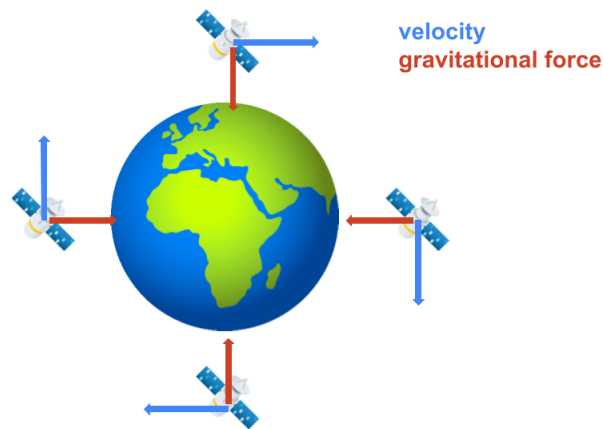
Solving for θ and substituting for the speed ($25 \text{ mph} \approx 11.18 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}}$) and radius:

$$\theta = \arctan\left(\frac{v^2}{gr}\right) = \arctan\left(\frac{(11.18 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}})^2}{(9.8 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}^2})(20\text{m})}\right)$$

$$\theta = \arctan(0.6377) \approx 32.53^\circ$$

8.6 Modeling Circular Motion

What causes circular motion is a constant force perpendicular to the motion. Consider a satellite circling the Earth. The only force acting on the satellite is gravity, yet the satellite does not fall to the Earth. Why? Let's look at the relative direction of motion and gravity for some different positions of the satellite (we'll assume this satellite is moving clockwise from our point of view):



No matter what position the satellite is in, the velocity and gravity vectors are perpendicular.

Exercise 16 **Circular Motion**

Just as your car rolls onto a circular track with a radius of 200 m, you realize your 0.4 kg cup of coffee is on the slippery dashboard of your car. While driving 120 km/hour, you hold the cup to keep it from sliding.

What is the maximum amount of force you would need to use? (The friction of the dashboard helps you, but the max is when the friction is zero.)

*Working Space**Answer on Page 88***Exercise 17** **Twirling a Whistle**

The lifeguard at a local pool is twirling their whistle horizontally. You wonder if the lifeguard could spin the whistle fast enough to break the string. The string the whistle is attached to can hold a maximum mass of 20 kg before breaking. If the lifeguard's whistle string is 0.35 m long and the average whistle has a mass of 165 grams, what is the maximum tangential speed the lifeguard can spin the whistle? How many rotations per second would the whistle be spinning at? Based on this, do you think the lifeguard is capable of spinning the whistle fast enough to break the string?

*Working Space**Answer on Page 88*

Exercise 18 The Gravitron

The Gravitron is a carnival ride where riders “stick” to the wall of a spinning cylinder as the floor beneath them drops away. A video explanation is given here:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ifAY5tbYDmQ>.

Draw a free body diagram of a rider. If the coefficient of friction between a rider and the wall is 0.32 and the ride is 10 meters across, what angular velocity must the ride reach before the floor drops away?

Working Space

Answer on Page 89

8.7 Flying Pigs and Tension

Take a look at the following two videos that involve flying pigs!

1. [Flying Pig: Uniform Circular Motion and Centripetal Force](#)
2. [flying pig - circular motion \[workthrough demo\]](#)

This involves a combination of circular motion and tension. Let’s say we have a pig at making angle θ with the vertical and the string of length L , causing the pig to move in a circular path with radius r . We can draw the following two diagrams for our pig, as shown in Figure 8.9.

Circular Motion at an angle

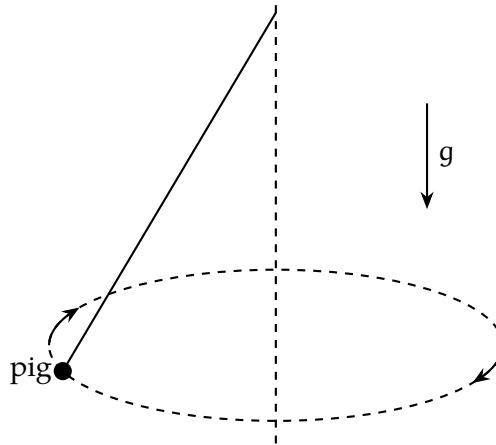


Figure 8.9: The uniform motion of a flying pig attached to a string.

If this is confusing, think of a tetherball from your local playground. It follows the same mechanics!

At any point, we can draw a free body diagram for the pig. Figure 8.10 shows the forces acting on the pig at all points.

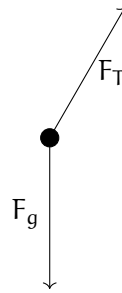


Figure 8.10: The FBD of the flying pig at any point.

To analyze the net forces, the tension force needs to be split into its x and y components. The y component of the tension force must balance out the weight of the pig (as it is not moving vertically), while the x component of the tension force provides the centripetal force to keep the pig moving in a circle.

$$\sum F_y = 0 \rightarrow F_{Ty} - F_g = 0 \rightarrow F_{Ty} = F_g = F_T \cos \theta = mg$$

The centripetal force is found by:

$$F_{T_x} = F_c = F_T \sin \theta = ma_r = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

Dividing the second equation by the first equation gives:

$$\frac{F_T \sin(\theta)}{F_T \cos(\theta)} = \frac{\frac{mv^2}{r}}{mg} \rightarrow \tan(\theta) = \frac{v^2}{rg}$$

Solving for θ gives us $\theta = \arctan\left(\frac{v^2}{rg}\right)$. We can also solve for v :

$$v = \sqrt{rg \tan \theta} = \sqrt{Lg \sin \theta \tan \theta}$$

Since r can be solved for θ using $r = L \sin \theta$.

Explicitly, we can express our tension force as $F_T = \frac{mg}{\cos(\theta)}$ (coming from our net force in the y -direction).

We can also explicitly solve for ω :

$$\begin{aligned}\tan(\theta) &= \frac{v^2}{rg} \\ &= \frac{(r\omega)^2}{rg} = \frac{r\omega^2}{g} \\ \omega^2 &= \frac{g \tan(\theta)}{r} \\ \omega &= \sqrt{\frac{g \tan(\theta)}{r}}\end{aligned}$$

What does all of this tell us?

- The vertical component of tension balances the weight of the pig, so there is no vertical motion.
- The horizontal component of tension provides the centripetal force that keeps the pig moving in a circle.
- The faster the pig moves, the larger the angle θ and the greater the tension in the string.
- The tension is always greater than the pig's weight: $F_T = \frac{mg}{\cos \theta}$.

- The angular speed required for a given angle is $\omega = \sqrt{\frac{g \tan \theta}{r}}$. This increases with larger angles, and decreases with a shorter radius.

Exercise 19 Playground Tetherball

Working Space

A tetherball of mass .5kg is attached to a string of length 2.5m. When the ball is swung around in a horizontal circle, the string makes an angle of 38° with the vertical. If the ball is in uniform circular motion, what is the speed of the ball?

Answer on Page 91

8.8 Non-uniform circular motion

We have talked enough about uniform circular motion, where the speed is constant. However, in many real-world scenarios, the speed is not constant. This is known as *non-uniform circular motion*. In this case, there are two components of acceleration: the centripetal acceleration $a_\perp$ (toward the center of the circle) and the tangential acceleration $a_\parallel$ (along the direction of motion). The tangential acceleration is responsible for changes in speed, while the centripetal acceleration is responsible for changes in direction. We will expand on this in the oscillations chapter, but this acceleration is caused by a *restoring force*, a force that tries to pull the object back toward equilibrium whenever it's displaced. We will introduce this concept here, but go into more detail in the oscillations chapter.

Let's look at a few examples of these concepts in action.

8.8.1 Roller Coaster Loop

Now we can talk about a roller coaster. A roller coaster loop is a great example of circular motion. As the roller coaster cart goes through the loop, it experiences both centripetal and tangential acceleration.

We will analyze the cart on a roller coaster at positions at the top, bottom, and sides of the loop, as shown in Figure 8.11

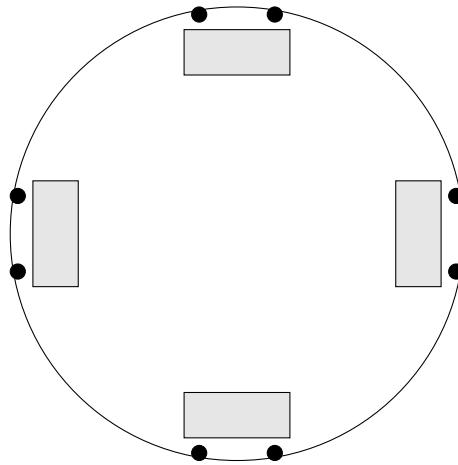


Figure 8.11: Carts at four positions around the loop with wheels on the track.

At the bottom

At the very bottom of the loop, the forces acting on the cart are gravity and the normal force from the track. Let's imagine the cart goes around the circular track infinitely without "exiting" the loop. There must, then, be a force keeping the cart moving in a circle. This force is the centripetal force, which points toward the center of the loop. The only two forces acting on the cart are gravity (downward) and the normal force from the track (upward). We know that a centripetal force must satisfy the formula $F_{\text{net}} = F_N - F_g = \frac{mv^2}{r}$. Therefore, the normal force must be greater than the weight of the cart at the bottom of the loop: $F_N = \frac{mv^2}{r} + mg$. This is represented in Figure 8.12.

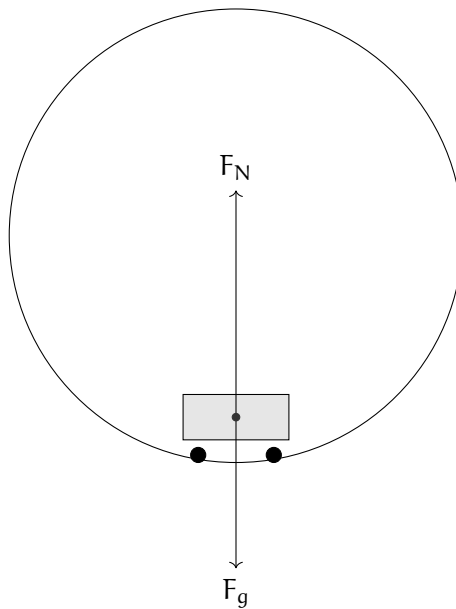


Figure 8.12: The FBD of the roller coaster at the bottom.

At the top

At the very top of the loop, the forces acting on the cart are gravity and the normal force from the track. Both forces point *downward* this time, toward the center of the loop. We can say that $F_{\text{net}} = F_N + F_g = \frac{mv^2}{r}$. Solving for the normal force gives: $F_N = \frac{mv^2}{r} - mg$.

Notice that the normal force is less than the weight of the cart at the top of the loop. This means that the centripetal acceleration would have to be greater than or equal mg . This is represented in Figure 8.13.

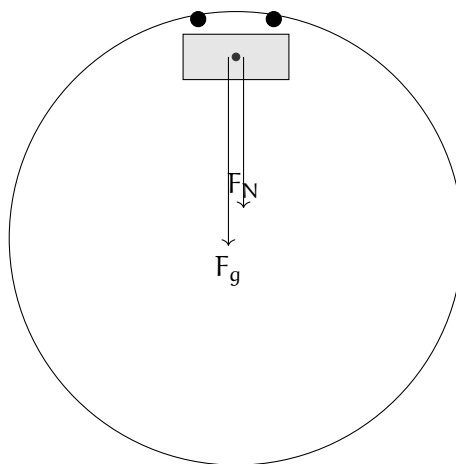


Figure 8.13: The FBD of the roller coaster at the top.

Note that for both the top and bottom of the loop, the minimum speed required to maintain contact with the track is given by $v = \sqrt{rg}$. If the cart goes any slower such that $v < \sqrt{rg}$, it will lose contact with the track, as there will not be enough normal force to provide the centripetal force needed to keep the cart moving in a circle. Think about where this observation comes from!

At the sides

Now at the sides of the loop (say 0 and π if we view the roller coaster as a unit circle), the net force is directed at an angle. The normal force from the track acts horizontally, pointing toward the center of the circle, while the gravitational force acts vertically downward. Since these two forces are perpendicular to each other, the net force is the vector sum of the normal and gravitational forces.

At the right side ($\theta = 0$), the normal force points leftward (toward the center), and gravity points downward, so the net force points diagonally down and to the left, toward the lower-left quadrant of the circle.

At the left side ($\theta = \pi$), the normal force points rightward (toward the center), and gravity still points downward, so the net force points diagonally down and to the right, toward the lower-left quadrant of the circle.

While the normal force provides the centripetal component of the net force, gravity introduces a tangential component, causing the cart to accelerate (speed up) along the track. Since the centripetal force is not directly towards the center of the circle, the cart must be speeding up. This is modeled in Figure 8.14.

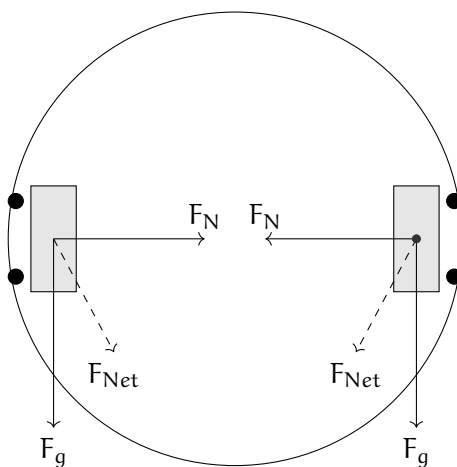


Figure 8.14: The FBD of the roller coaster at the sides.

Exercise 20 **Roller Coaster Loop**

This question is taken from the AP Physics C Review Book, 19th edition.

Working Space

A roller-coaster car enters the circular loop portion of the ride. At the very top of the circle (where people are upside down), the car has a speed of 25 m/s, and the acceleration points straight down. If the diameter of the loop is 50 m and the total mass of the car plus passengers is 1,200 kg, find the magnitude of the normal force exerted by the track on the car at this point. Also find the normal force exerted by the track on the car when it is at the very bottom of the loop, given it is still traveling at 25 m/s. You may use $g = 10 \text{ m/s}^2$ for simpler calculations.

Answer on Page 91

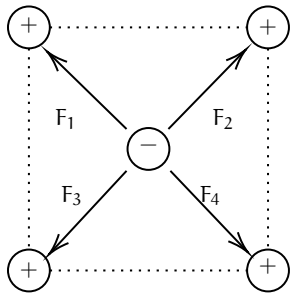
Our next chapter will explore oscillations, restoring forces, simple harmonic motion, and more concepts of harmonic motion.

Answers to Exercises

Answer to Exercise 1 (on page 4)

$$F = k \frac{|q_1 q_2|}{r^2} = (8.988 \times 10^9) \frac{(-5 \times 10^{-9})(-5 \times 10^{-9})}{0.12^2} = \frac{224.7 \times 10^{-9}}{0.0144} = 15.6 \times 10^{-6} \text{ N or } 15.6 \text{ micronewtons}$$

Answer to Exercise 2 (on page 6)



The attractive forces of F_1 and F_3 cancel each other out. Similarly, the attractive forces of F_2 and F_4 also cancel each other out. The net charge on the negative point charge is zero.

Answer to Exercise 3 (on page 8)

We noted above that the electric field caused by a point charge is defined as $E = \frac{kq}{r^2}$. We need to find the electric fields for each charge and then subtract their strengths.

Inputting known variables as constants for X from point P:

$$E = \frac{kQ}{d^2}$$

And doing the same for Y:

$$E = \frac{2kQ}{(2d)^2} = \frac{kQ}{2d^2}$$

Because the fields are in opposite directions, we subtract the smaller magnitude from the larger one. Let's define *to the right* as the positive direction:

$$E_{\text{net}} = E_X - E_Y \implies \frac{kQ}{d^2} - \frac{kQ}{2d^2}$$

To subtract, we find a common denominator:

$$E_{\text{net}} = \frac{2kQ}{2d^2} - \frac{kQ}{2d^2} = \frac{kQ}{2d^2}$$

The correct answer is C.

Answer to Exercise 4 (on page 13)

The amount of charge dQ on a small *surface* section of the belt is $dq = \sigma dA$. For a belt of width w , the area passing the wire in time dt is $dA = w(v dt)$. Substituting this in:

$$I = \frac{\sigma(w \cdot v \cdot dt)}{dt} = \sigma \cdot w \cdot v \quad (1.12)$$

Plugging in our values:

$$I = (5.0 \times 10^{-3} \text{ C/m}^2) \cdot (0.60 \text{ m}) \cdot (2.5 \text{ m/s})$$

$$I = 7.5 \times 10^{-3} \text{ A} = 7.5 \text{ mA}$$

Answer to Exercise 5 (on page 14)

Since the field is uniform, the charge has a constant electric force felt on it: $\vec{F}_E = q\vec{E}$. Since q is positive, $\vec{F}_E$ points in the same direction as $\vec{E}$. Because the force and the displacement r are in the same direction, the work W_E done by the electric field is positive:

$$W_E = F_E \cdot r = qEr$$

Thus the change in electric potential energy is

$$\Delta U_E = -qEr$$

It is *negative* because a doing positive work results in negative change in potential energy.

Answer to Exercise 6 (on page 15)

Using our equations, we can derive an equation for the potential difference V :

$$\begin{aligned}\Delta U_E &= q\Delta V \\ W_E &= \Delta U_E \\ W_E &= qV \\ \text{gain in kinetic energy} &= \text{work done by field} \\ \frac{1}{2}mv^2 &= qV \\ V &= \frac{1}{2} \frac{mv^2}{q}\end{aligned}$$

Since our we are given the speed, and the charge and mass of the electron, we can plug in our values:

$$\begin{aligned}V &= \frac{\frac{1}{2}(9.11 \times 10^{-31})(9.4 \times 10^6)^2}{1.60 \times 10^{-19}} \\ &= \frac{\frac{1}{2}(9.11 \times 10^{-31})(8.836 \times 10^{13})}{1.60 \times 10^{-19}} \\ &= \frac{\frac{1}{2}(8.05 \times 10^{-17})}{1.60 \times 10^{-19}} \\ &= \frac{\frac{1}{2}(8.05 \times 10^{-17})}{1.60 \times 10^{-19}} \\ &= \frac{4.03 \times 10^{-17}}{1.60 \times 10^{-19}} \\ &= 252 \text{ V}\end{aligned}$$

So each coulomb of charge is accelerated by a potential difference of 252 volts. And since the electron has a charge of $1.6 \times 10^{-19} \text{ C}$, the total energy gained by the electron is all transferred into kinetic energy.

Answer to Exercise 7 (on page 17)

First off, why do we know that the electron will hit a plate? Because the electric field between the plate exerts a force on the electron. The electron is attracted to the **positively** charged upper plate, so it will accelerate upwards and eventually hit the upper plate. Let's first find. the acceleration caused by the electric field. The electric field strength E

between two parallel plates is given by:

$$E = \frac{V}{d} = \frac{30}{0.040} = 750 \text{ V m}^{-1} \quad (1.20)$$

Converting this to solve for the electron's acceleration:

$$a = \frac{F}{m} = \frac{qE}{m} = \frac{(1.6 \times 10^{-19})(750)}{9.11 \times 10^{-31}} \approx 1.32 \times 10^{14} \text{ m s}^{-2} \quad (1.21)$$

To find the horizontal distance travelled, we use the vertical motion to find time, and then use that time to find the horizontal distance travelled. The vertical motion is a simple kinematics problem with constant acceleration:

$$\begin{aligned} y &= v_{y0}t + \frac{1}{2}a_y t^2 \\ 0.02 &= 0 + \frac{1}{2}(1.32 \times 10^{14})t^2 \\ t^2 &= \frac{0.04}{1.32 \times 10^{14}} \\ t &\approx 1.74 \times 10^{-8} \text{ s} \end{aligned}$$

Then, putting this into a horizontal motion equation:

$$\begin{aligned} x &= v_{x0}t \\ &= (9.4 \times 10^6)(1.74 \times 10^{-8}) \\ &\approx 0.16 \text{ m} \end{aligned}$$

So the electron travels a horizontal distance of about **0.16 meters** before hitting the upper plate.

Answer to Exercise 8 (on page 28)

The change in magnetic flux is:

$$\Delta\Phi_B = \Delta B \cdot A = (5 \text{ T} \times 0.2 \text{ m}^2) = 1 \text{ Wb}$$

The induced emf is:

$$\mathcal{E} = -N \cdot \frac{\Delta\Phi_B}{\Delta t} = -100 \cdot \frac{1 \text{ Wb}}{0.1 \text{ s}} = -1000 \text{ V}$$

The magnitude of the induced emf is 1000 V.

Answer to Exercise 9 (on page 39)

The force of gravity is $9.8 \times 45 = 441$ newtons.

At any speed s , the force of wind resistance is $0.05 \times s^2 = 0.05s^2$ newtons.

At terminal velocity, $0.05s^2 = 441$.

Solving for s , we get $s = \sqrt{\frac{441}{0.05}}$

Thus, terminal velocity should be about 94 m/s.

Answer to Exercise 10 (on page 44)

To sketch the curve, we begin by choosing several values of t and computing the corresponding x - and y -values.

t	x	y
-2	-1	4
-1	0	1
0	1	0
1	2	1
2	3	4

Plotting these points produces a parabola opening upward. As t increases, the x -values increase and the curve is traced from left to right.

Although the rectangular equation of the curve is

$$y = (x - 1)^2,$$

the parametric equations determine the direction in which the curve is drawn, which cannot be seen from the rectangular form alone.

Answer to Exercise 11 (on page 47)

To sketch the curve, we begin by evaluating the parametric equations at several values of t .

t	x	y
0	4	3
1	2	5
2	0	-1
3	-2	-15

Plotting these points produces a curve that opens downward. As t increases, the x -values decrease, indicating that the curve is traced from right to left.

The Python animation confirms this behavior by showing the curve being drawn progressively as t increases. The moving point illustrates both the direction of motion and how the curve is traced over time, reinforcing the hand-drawn sketch.

Answer to Exercise 12 (on page 50)

First compute the derivatives:

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = 3t^2 - 3, \quad \frac{dy}{dt} = 2t.$$

Horizontal tangents occur when $\frac{dy}{dt} = 0$ and $\frac{dx}{dt} \neq 0$.

$$2t = 0 \Rightarrow t = 0.$$

At $t = 0$, the point on the curve is

$$x = 0, \quad y = 0.$$

Vertical tangents occur when $\frac{dx}{dt} = 0$ and $\frac{dy}{dt} \neq 0$.

$$3t^2 - 3 = 0 \Rightarrow t = \pm 1.$$

At $t = 1$, the point is

$$(-2, 1),$$

and at $t = -1$, the point is

$$(2, 1).$$

Answer to Exercise 13 (on page 51)

First compute the derivatives with respect to t :

$$\frac{dx}{dt} = 2, \quad \frac{dy}{dt} = 2t.$$

The derivative of the curve is

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{dy/dt}{dx/dt} = \frac{2t}{2} = t.$$

At $t = 1$,

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = 1.$$

Thus, the slope of the tangent line at the corresponding point on the curve is 1.

Answer to Exercise 14 (on page 54)

Two sets of parametric equations can represent the same graph but describe different curves because the parameter controls how the graph is traced, not just the shape of the graph itself.

Different parametric equations may generate the same set of points in the plane while differing in one or more of the following ways:

- the direction of motion along the curve,
- the speed at which the curve is traced,
- the starting point of the curve,
- or the number of times the curve is traced.

Answer to Exercise 15 (on page 64)

The radius is 5 m, because the coefficients of both the x and y functions is 5.

Recall that the velocity in each direction is given by the derivative of the position functions:

$$v_x(t) = \frac{d}{dt} [5 \cos(3t)] = -15 \sin(3t)$$

$$v_y(t) = \frac{d}{dt} [5 \sin(3t)] = 15 \cos(3t)$$

The overall *speed* can be found from the x and y components of the velocity:

$$\begin{aligned} |v| &= \sqrt{v_x^2 + v_y^2} \\ &= \sqrt{[-15 \sin(3t)]^2 + [15 \cos(3t)]^2} \\ &= \sqrt{15^2 [\sin^2(3t) + \cos^2(3t)]} \\ &= \sqrt{15^2} = 15 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}} \end{aligned}$$

Notice that this is the coefficient for both components of the velocity.

To complete the path, the particle must travel 10π m. If the speed is $15 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}}$, then the time it takes is:

$$t = \frac{d}{v} = \frac{10\pi \text{ m}}{15 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}}} = \frac{2\pi}{3} \text{ s} \approx 2.09 \text{ s}$$

Answer to Exercise 16 (on page 71)

$$\frac{120 \text{ km}}{1 \text{ hour}} = \frac{1000 \text{ m}}{1 \text{ km}} \frac{120 \text{ km}}{1 \text{ hour}} \frac{1 \text{ hour}}{3600 \text{ seconds}} = 33.3 \text{ m/s}$$

$$F = \frac{mv^2}{r} = \frac{0.4(33.3)^2}{200} = 2.2 \text{ newtons}$$

Answer to Exercise 17 (on page 71)

Givens:

$$T_{\max} = (20 \text{ kg}) \cdot \left(9.8 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}^2}\right) = 196 \text{ N}$$

$$r = 0.35 \text{ m}$$

$$m_{\text{whistle}} = 165 \text{ g} = 0.165 \text{ kg}$$

Unknown:

$$v = ?$$

$$f = ?$$

Equation(s):

$$F = ma$$

$$a = \frac{v^2}{r}$$

$$v = rf$$

Solution: First, we find the tangential speed if the tension in the string is the maximum tension:

$$T_{\max} = m_{\text{whistle}} a = m_{\text{whistle}} \frac{v^2}{r}$$

$$v = \sqrt{\frac{T_{\max} r}{m_{\text{whistle}}}}$$

$$v = \sqrt{\frac{196\text{N} (0.35\text{m})}{0.165\text{kg}}} \approx 0.645 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}}$$

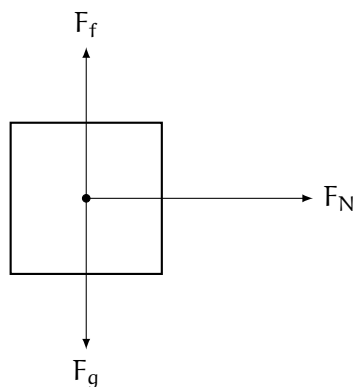
Therefore, the maximum tangential speed of the whistle before the string breaks is $0.645 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}}$. Now finding the equivalent frequency (rotations per second):

$$f = \frac{v}{r} = \frac{0.645 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}}}{0.35\text{m}} \approx 1.842\text{Hz}$$

So, to break the string, the lifeguard would have to spin it at nearly 2 rotations per second, which is achievable. The lifeguard could possibly break the string.

Answer to Exercise 18 (on page 72)

There are three forces acting on the rider: gravity, friction with the wall, and the normal force with the wall:



The FBD lets us write equations for Newton's Second Law in each dimension:

$$(1) \quad ma_x = F_N$$

$$(2) \quad ma_y = F_f - F_g = \mu F_N - mg$$

Because the rider doesn't fall down, we know that $a_y = 0 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}^2}$ and therefore equation (2) becomes:

$$\mu F_N - mg = 0 \rightarrow F_N = \frac{mg}{\mu}$$

Having solved for F_N , we substitute for it into equation (1):

$$ma_x = \frac{mg}{\mu} \rightarrow a_x = \frac{g}{\mu}$$

Since we know g and μ , we can calculate a_x :

$$a_x = \frac{9.8 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}^2}}{0.32} = 30.625 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}^2}$$

This is the minimum acceleration needed to keep the rider from slipping down. We can now use the relationship between centripetal acceleration, tangential velocity, and the radius to find the angular velocity:

$$a = \frac{v^2}{r} = \frac{(\omega r)^2}{r} = \omega^2 r$$

$$\omega = \sqrt{\frac{a}{r}} = \sqrt{\frac{30.625 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}^2}}{10 \text{ m}}} \approx 1.75 \frac{\text{rad}}{\text{s}}$$

Answer to Exercise 19 (on page 75)

Givens:

- Mass of tetherball: $m = 0.5 \text{ kg}$
- Length of string: $L = 2.5 \text{ m}$
- Angle with vertical: $\theta = 38^\circ$

The components of the tension force are separated as follows:

$$T \cos \theta = mg, \quad T \sin \theta = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

Dividing the second equation by the first equation gives:

$$\tan \theta = \frac{v^2}{rg} \rightarrow v = \sqrt{rg \tan \theta}$$

But we are not given r . We can find r using trigonometry:

$$r = L \sin \theta$$

Now we can find v :

$$v = \sqrt{(L \sin \theta)g \tan \theta}$$

Solving this gives us:

$$v = \sqrt{(2.5 \text{ m} \sin 38^\circ)(9.8 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}^2}) \tan 38^\circ} \approx 3.4 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}}$$

The speed of the tetherball is approximately $3.4 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}}$.

Answer to Exercise 20 (on page 79)

- At the top of the loop: At the top of the loop, both the gravitational force and the normal force point downward. Therefore, we can write:

$$F_{\text{net}} = F_N + F_g = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

Solving for the normal force gives:

$$F_N = \frac{mv^2}{r} - F_g$$

Substituting for $F_g = mg$ and $r = \frac{d}{2} = 25 \text{ m}$:

$$F_N = \frac{(1200 \text{ kg})(25 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}})^2}{25 \text{ m}} - (1200 \text{ kg})(10 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}^2})$$

$$F_N = 30000 \text{ N} - 12000 \text{ N} = 18000 \text{ N}$$

- At the bottom of the loop: At the bottom of the loop, the gravitational force points downward while the normal force points upward. Therefore, we can write:

$$F_{\text{net}} = F_N - F_g = \frac{mv^2}{r}$$

Solving for the normal force gives:

$$F_N = \frac{mv^2}{r} + F_g$$

Substituting for $F_g = mg$ and $r = \frac{d}{2} = 25 \text{ m}$:

$$F_N = \frac{(1200 \text{ kg})(25 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}})^2}{25 \text{ m}} + (1200 \text{ kg})(10 \frac{\text{m}}{\text{s}^2})$$

$$F_N = 30000 \text{ N} + 12000 \text{ N} = 42000 \text{ N}$$



INDEX

- Alternating Current, 23
- Alternating Current
 - graphed, 24
 - phased, 26
 - transformers, 25
- angular velocity, 63
- angular velocity,, 62
- atoms, 5
- attraction, 5
- centripetal
 - acceleration, 67
 - force, 68
- centripetal acceleration, 67
- centripetal force, 61, 68
- circular motion, 62
 - equations, 61
 - velocity, 64
- continuous charge distributions, 13
- coulombs, 5
 - Coulomb's law, 5
- Direct Current, 23
- electric field, 9
 - units, 9
- electric flux, 12
- electric force, 5
- Electric Motor, 33
- Electric Motor
 - Generator, 33
- electric potential energy, 15
- electrical charge, 5
- Electromagnetic Induction, 29
- electromagnetic induction, 33
- electrons, 5
- elementary charge, *see also* coulombs
- Faraday's Law of Induction, 29
- Gauss's Law, 13
- induction, 26
- lightning, 19
- Linear velocity, 61
- linear velocity, 63
- net charge, 5
- non-uniform circular motion, 77
- parameter, 43
- Period, 61
- phase, 26
- point charge, 7
- principle of superposition, 8
- protons, 5
- quantized, 5
- repel, 5
- restoring force, 77
- terminal velocity, 41

transformer, [25](#)

vector-valued, [57](#)

wind resistance, [37](#)